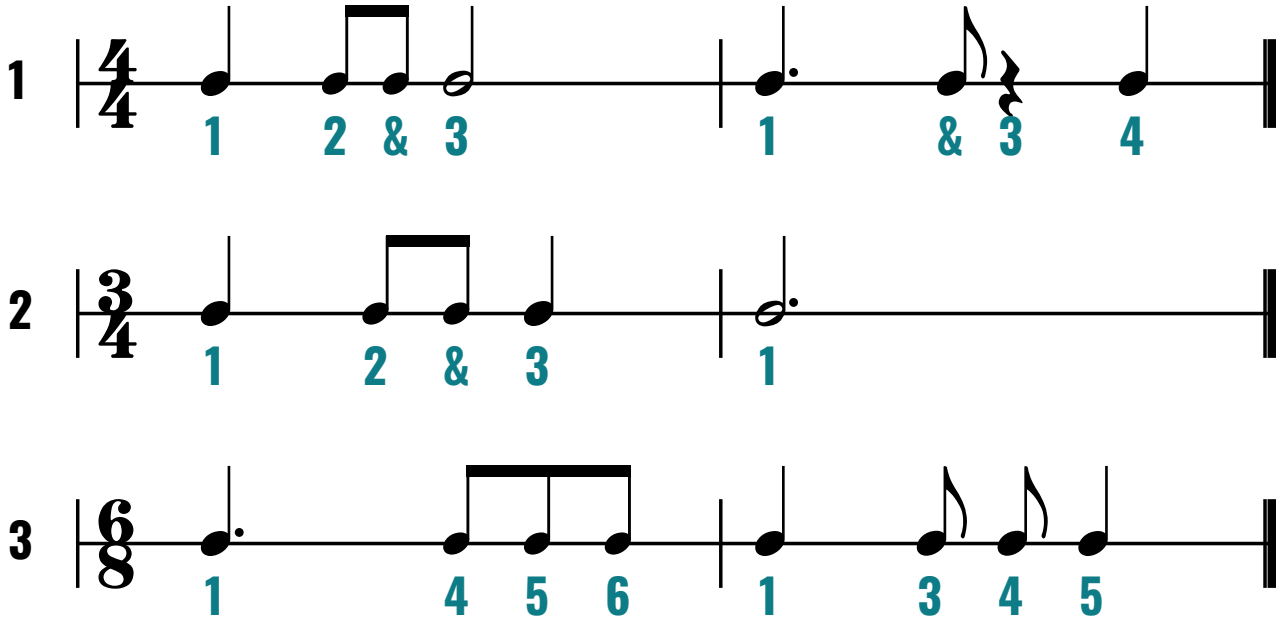
HUDSON BEAT



BEGINNING BAND RHYTHM COUNTING

Write in the counts · quarter notes to dotted rhythms and 6/8 — with answer keys

GRADES 5–8 · 20 WORKSHEETS · ANSWER KEYS

TEACHER NOTES

Band Rhythm Counting Worksheets · 20 worksheets · grades 5–8

HOW TO USE

- Students look at the time signature, then write the count in the box under every note and every rest.
- **Write the count where each note or rest begins.** A half note on beat 1 gets a 1; the 2 is held, so nothing is written for it.
- Rests are counted exactly like notes. They are silent beats, not skipped ones.
- In 4/4, 3/4 and 2/4 the beat is a quarter note: count 1 2 3 4, and write **&** for the half beat between (the "and" of a beat).
- In 6/8 the eighth note gets one count: count 1 2 3 4 5 6. Counts 1 and 4 are the strong pulses. If you count 6/8 in two (1-la-li 2-la-li), write the numbers 1–6 anyway.
- Check with the answer key, or clap, tap or play on one note with the class: say the counts aloud, then play.
- Print single-sided. Every worksheet has 6 lines of two or three measures.

GREAT FOR

- Band, orchestra and general music, grades 5–8
- Warm-ups, homework, sub plans and rhythm quizzes
- Practice before sight-reading or a new method-book page

UNIT GUIDE

UNIT	SKILL	SHEETS	PAGES
Unit 1	Quarter, half and whole notes and rests (4/4)	Worksheets 1–4	pp. 4–7
Unit 2	3/4 and 2/4 time	Worksheets 5–6	pp. 8–9
Unit 3	Dotted half notes	Worksheets 7–8	pp. 10–11
Unit 4	Eighth notes and eighth rests	Worksheets 9–12	pp. 12–15
Unit 5	Dotted quarter and eighth	Worksheets 13–14	pp. 16–17
Unit 6	6/8 time	Worksheets 15–17	pp. 18–20
Unit 7	Mixed review and challenge	Worksheets 18–20	pp. 21–23

Pages 4–23 are the worksheets. Pages 24–33 are the answer keys: two worksheets per page, with the count written in accent color under every note and rest. Page 3 is a student reference for note values and counting.

STANDARDS

Practices reading, counting and understanding rhythm and meter. Supports the National Core Arts Standards for Music, Performing (MU:Pr4.2, understanding the elements of music), in grades 5–8.

GOOD TO KNOW

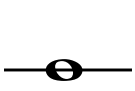
The rhythms are written on a one-line staff so students focus on counting, not pitch. Every line is generated and checked so that its measures add up to the time signature; the keys are built from the same data as the worksheets. Notes of the same line are beamed by beat. No ties, no sixteenth notes and no songs are used. No songs, lyrics or copyrighted characters are used.

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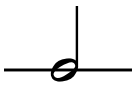
STUDENT REFERENCE

Keep this page nearby while you count.

NOTE AND REST VALUES · (in 4/4, 3/4 and 2/4)



WHOLE NOTE
4 beats



HALF NOTE
2 beats



QUARTER NOTE
1 beat



EIGHTH NOTE
½ beat



DOTTED HALF NOTE
3 beats



DOTTED QUARTER NOTE
1½ beats

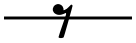
WHOLE REST
4 beats of silence



HALF REST
2 beats of silence



QUARTER REST
1 beat of silence



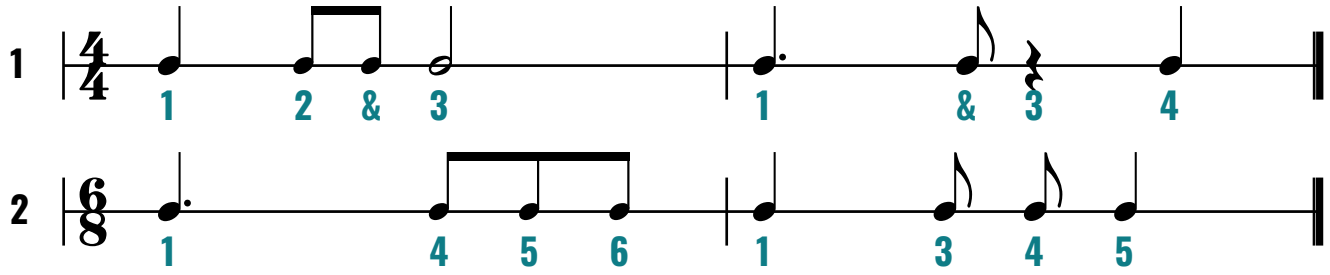
EIGHTH REST
½ beat of silence

A dot after a note makes it half as long again: a half note is 2 beats, a dotted half note is 2 + 1 = 3 beats; a quarter note is 1 beat, a dotted quarter note is 1 + ½ = 1½ beats.

READING THE TIME SIGNATURE

METER	TOP NUMBER	BOTTOM NUMBER	COUNT IT
4/4	4 beats in a measure	quarter note = 1 beat	1 2 3 4 · eighths: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &
3/4	3 beats in a measure	quarter note = 1 beat	1 2 3 · eighths: 1 & 2 & 3 &
2/4	2 beats in a measure	quarter note = 1 beat	1 2 · eighths: 1 & 2 &
6/8	6 counts in a measure	eighth note = 1 count	1 2 3 4 5 6

COUNTING IN 4/4 AND 6/8



In 6/8 a quarter note is 2 counts, a dotted quarter note is 3 counts and a dotted half note is 6 counts. Write the count under the place where each note begins.

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RHYTHM COUNTING

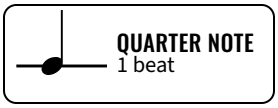
WORKSHEET 1

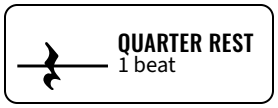
1. Quarter notes and quarter rests

Unit 1 · 4/4

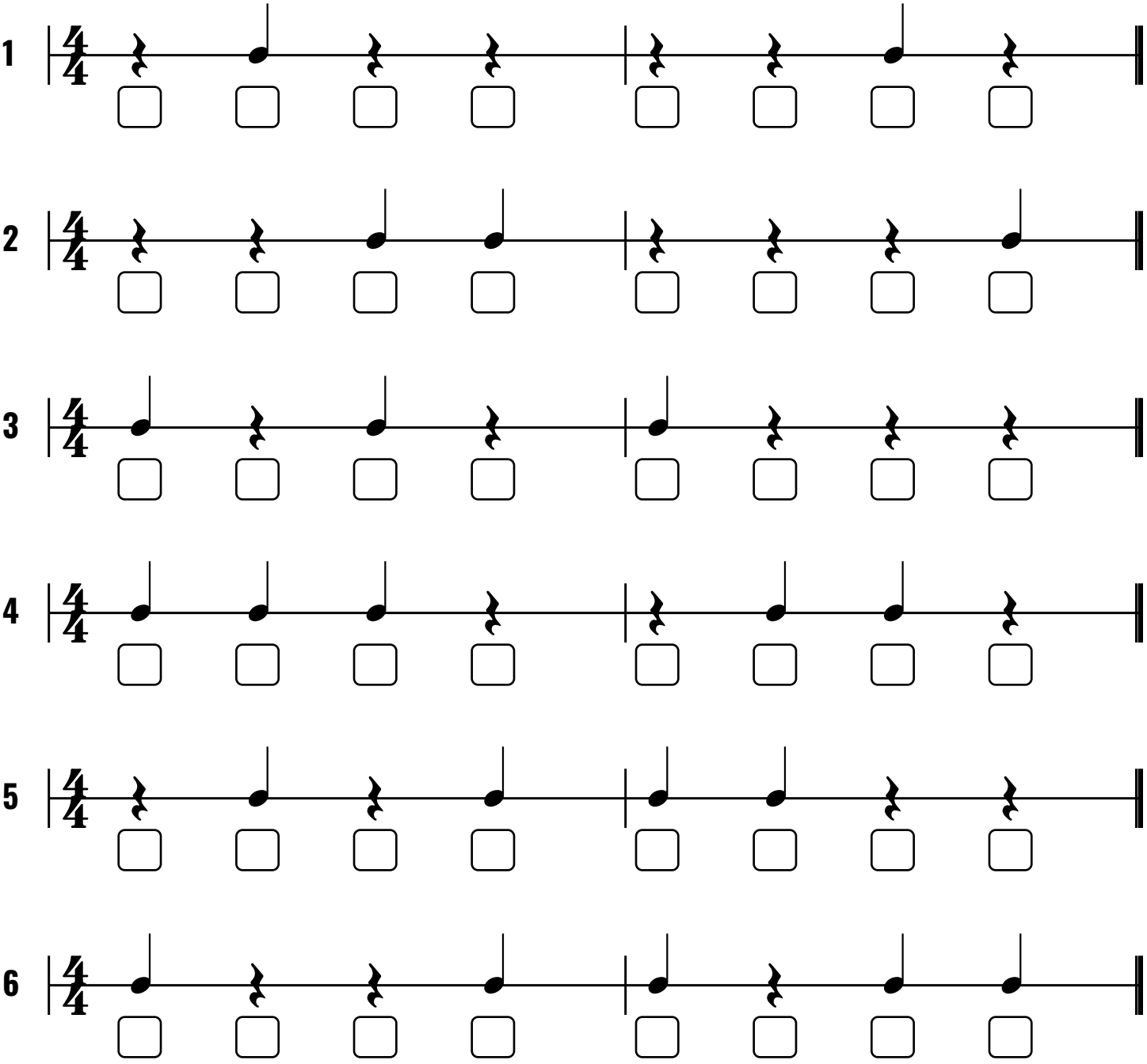
Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. Count every note and rest. Each quarter note or rest gets one beat. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.





Counts to use: 4/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 2

2. Half notes

Unit 1 · 4/4

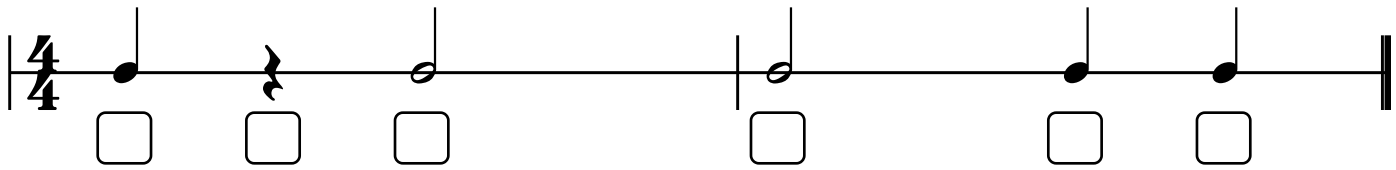
Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. A half note lasts 2 beats. Write the count where the note begins. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

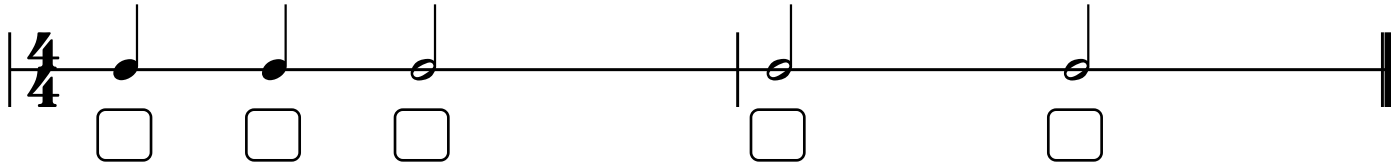
HALF NOTE	QUARTER NOTE	QUARTER REST
2 beats	1 beat	1 beat

Counts to use: 4/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &

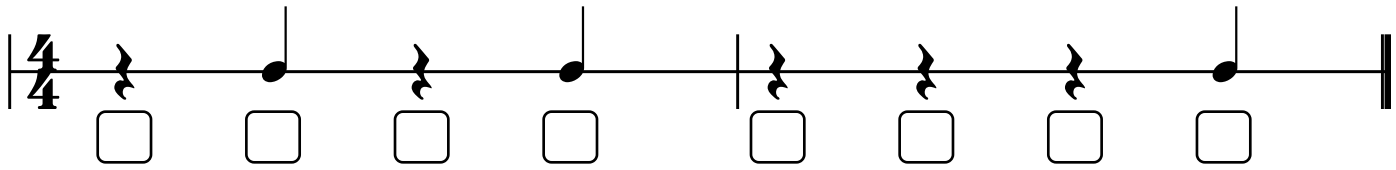
1



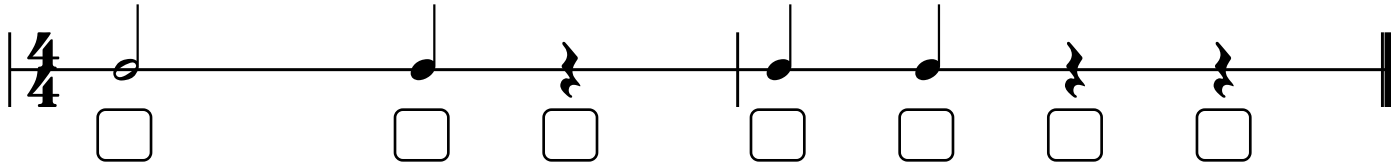
2



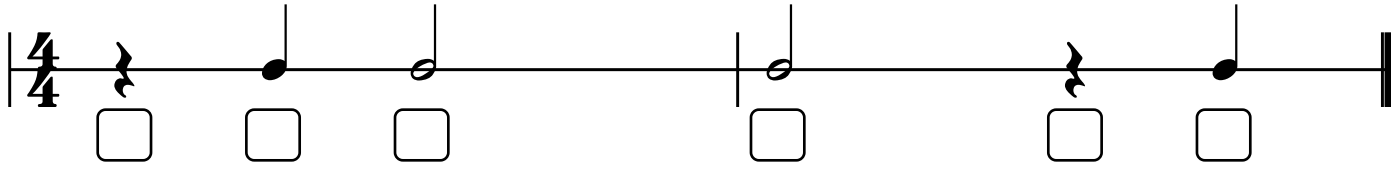
3



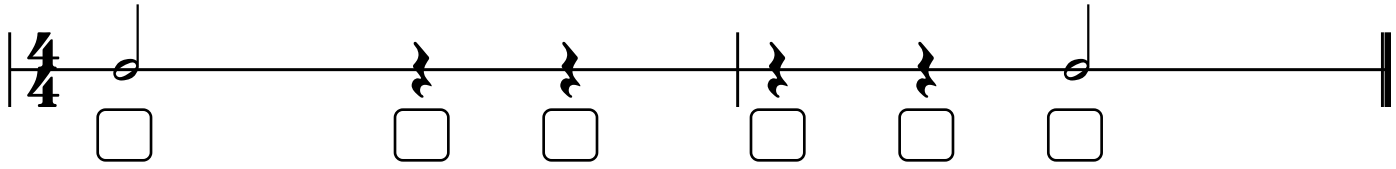
4



5



6



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 3

3. Half rests

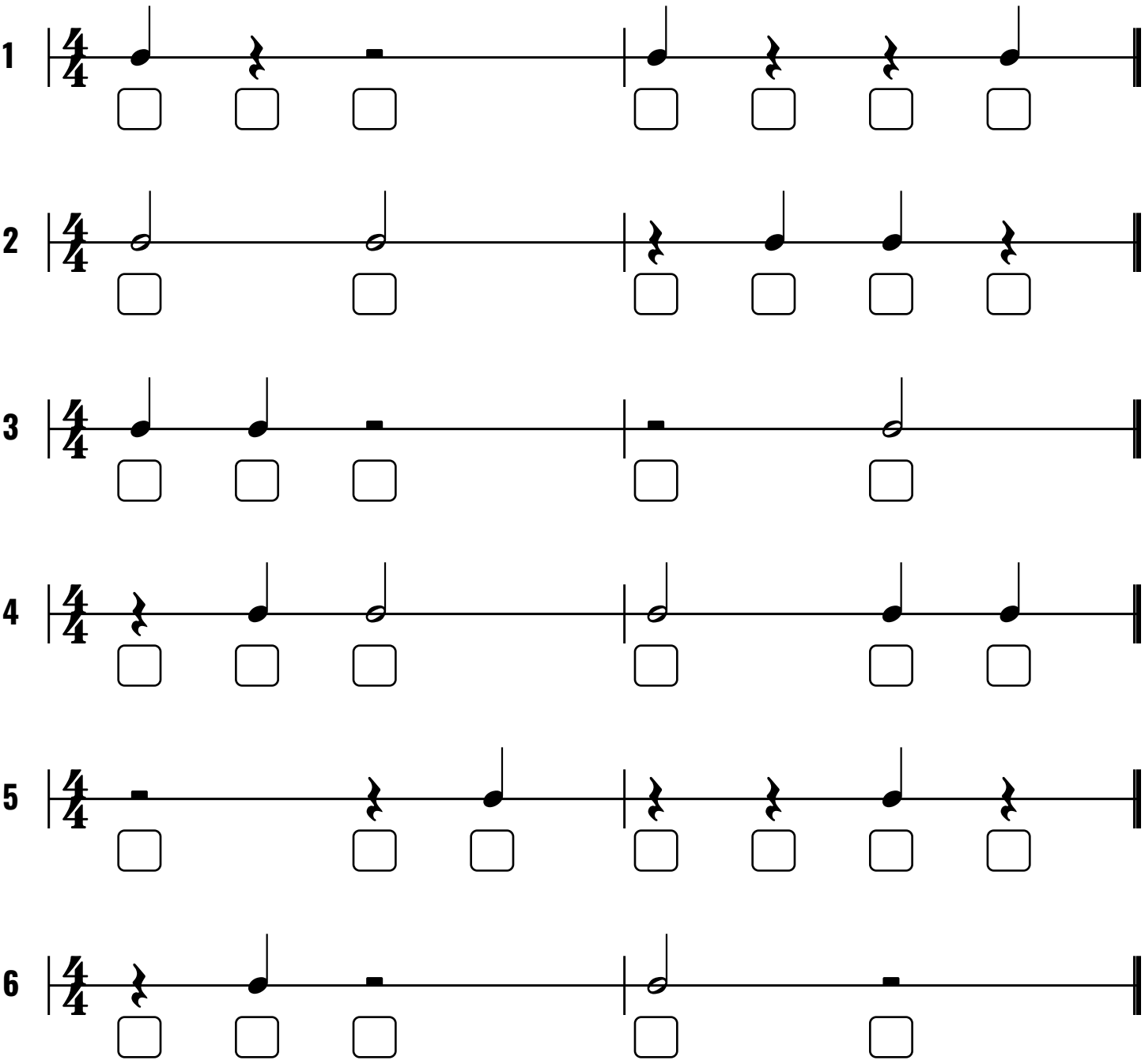
Unit 1 · 4/4

Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. A half rest is 2 beats of silence. Count it like a note. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

HALF NOTE	QUARTER NOTE	HALF REST	QUARTER REST
2 beats	1 beat	2 beats	1 beat

Counts to use: 4/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 4

4. Whole notes and whole rests

Unit 1 · 4/4

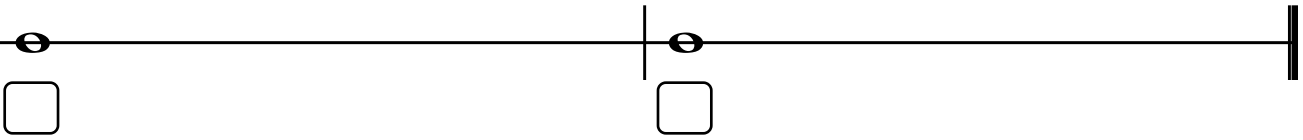
Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. A whole note or rest fills a whole measure of 4/4. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

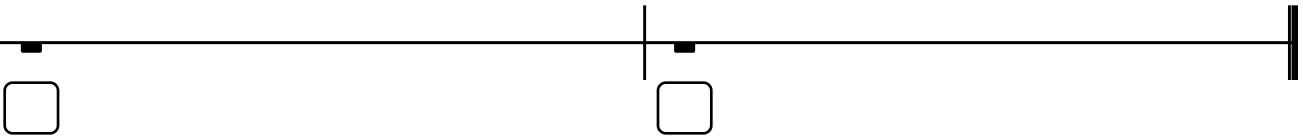
WHOLE NOTE	HALF NOTE	QUARTER NOTE	WHOLE REST	HALF REST
4 beats	2 beats	1 beat	4 beats	2 beats

Counts to use: 4/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &

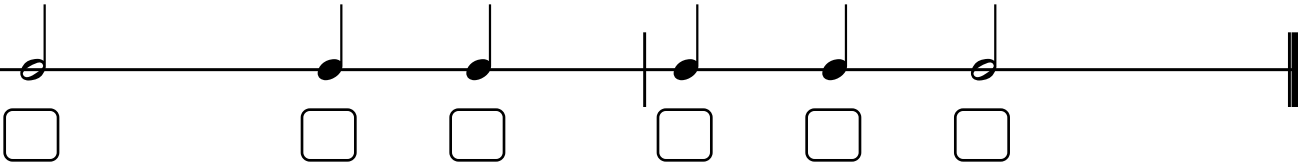
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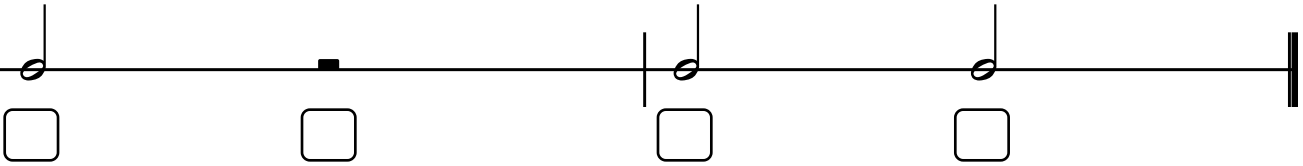
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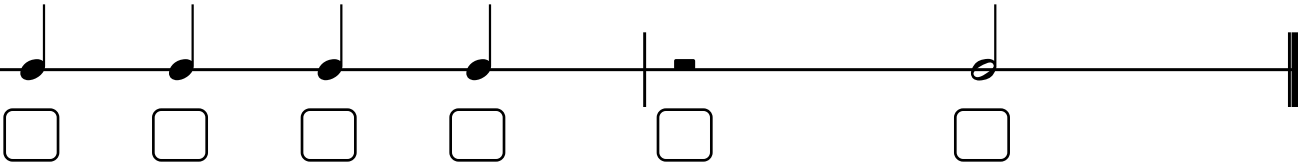
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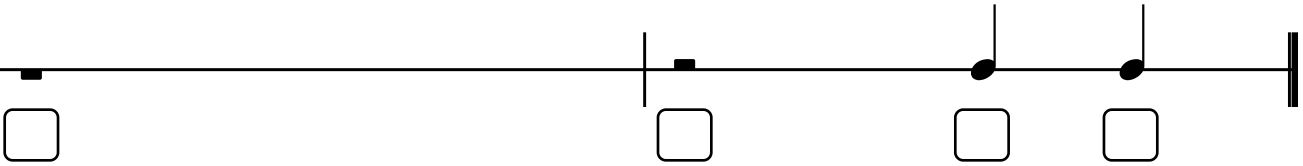
4



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 5

5. Three-four time

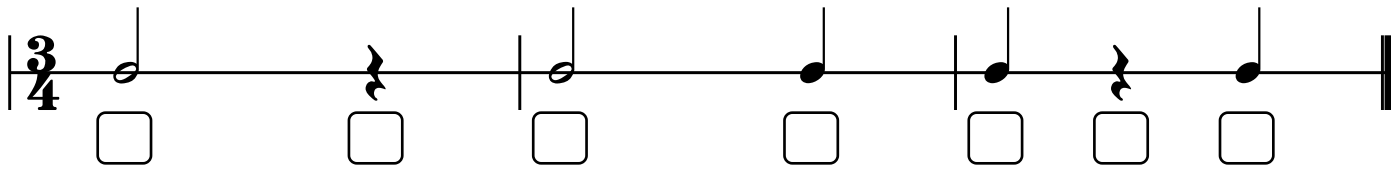
Unit 2 · 3/4

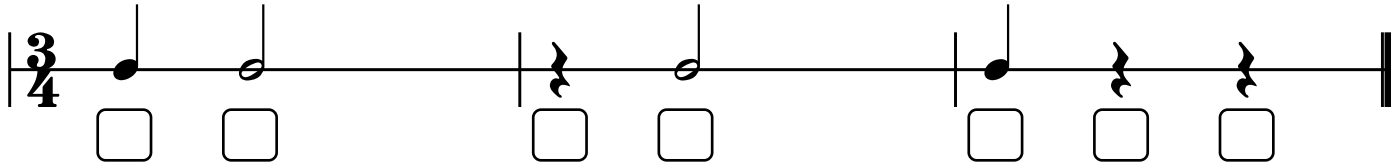
Name _____ Date _____

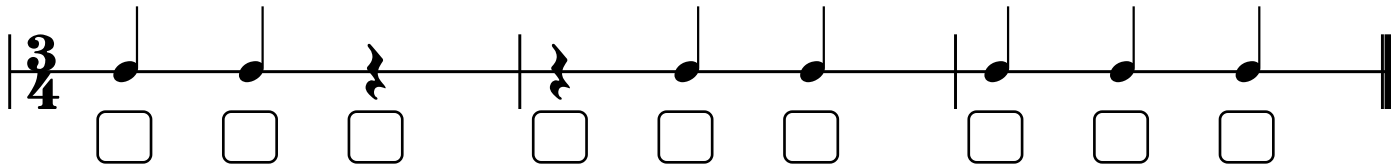
Write in the counts. In 3/4 there are 3 beats in every measure. Count 1 2 3. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

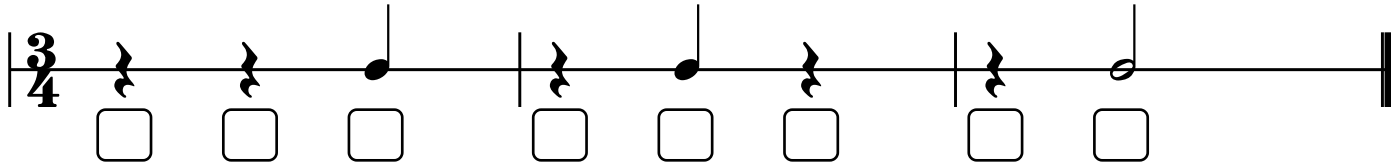
HALF NOTE	QUARTER NOTE	QUARTER REST
2 beats	1 beat	1 beat

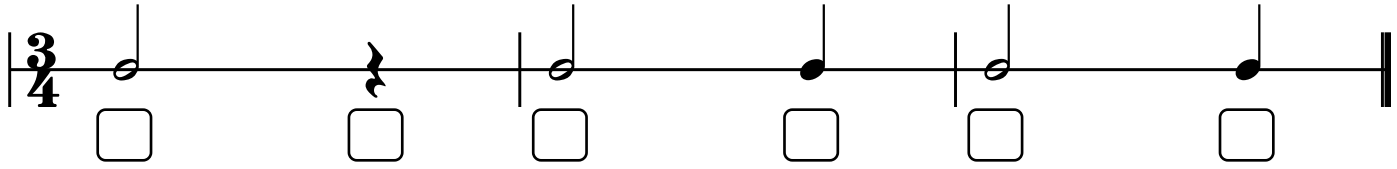
Counts to use: 3/4: 1 & 2 & 3 &

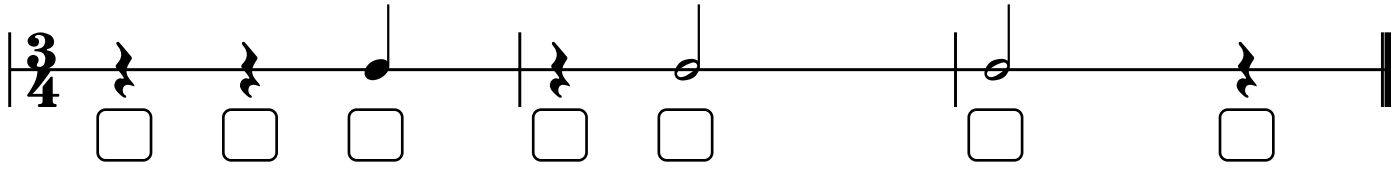
1 

2 

3 

4 

5 

6 

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RHYTHM COUNTING

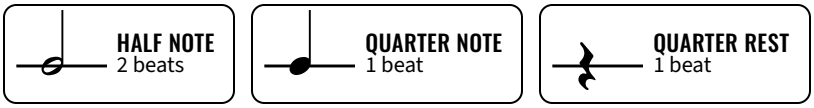
WORKSHEET 6

6. Two-four time

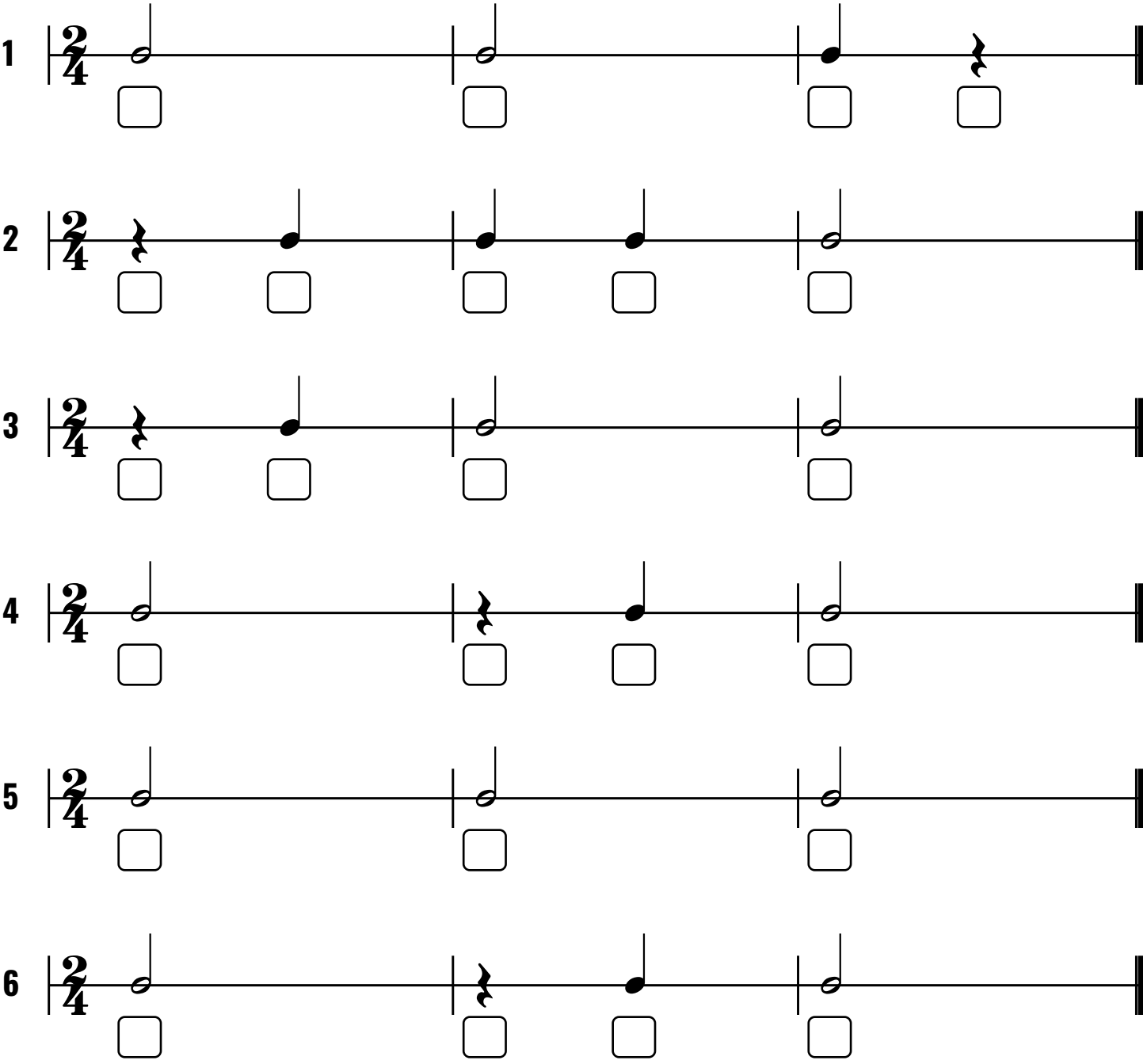
Unit 2 · 2/4

Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. In 2/4 there are 2 beats in every measure. Count 1 2. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.



Counts to use: 2/4: 1 & 2 &



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RHYTHM COUNTING

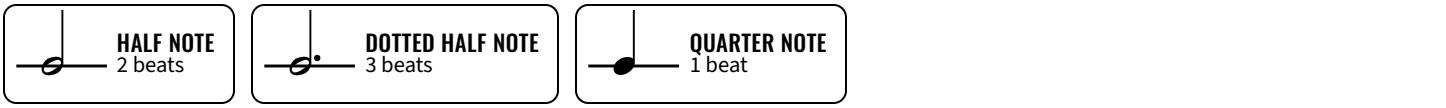
WORKSHEET 7

7. Dotted half notes in 3/4

Unit 3 · 3/4

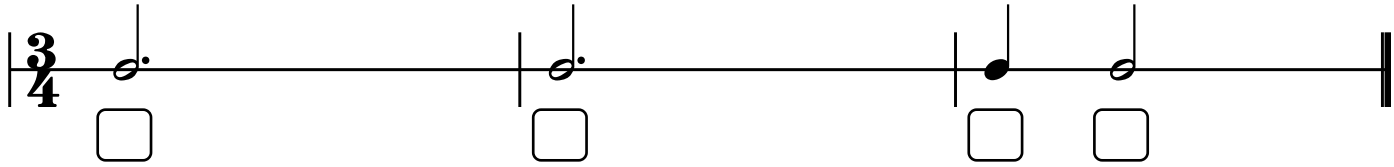
Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. A dot adds half the note's value: a dotted half note lasts 3 beats. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

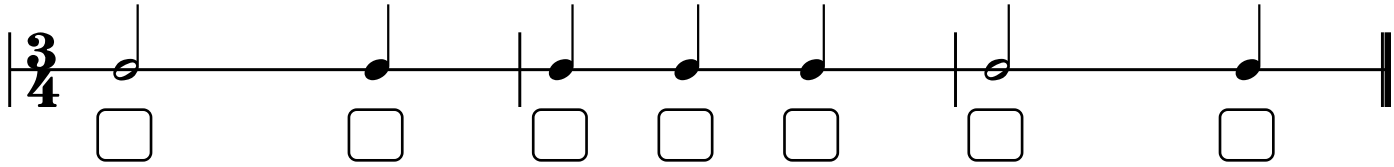


Counts to use: 3/4: 1 & 2 & 3 &

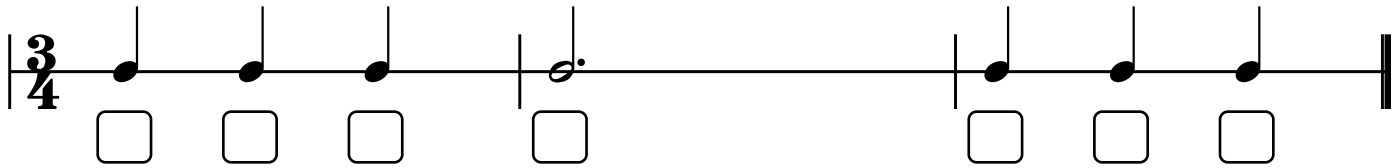
1



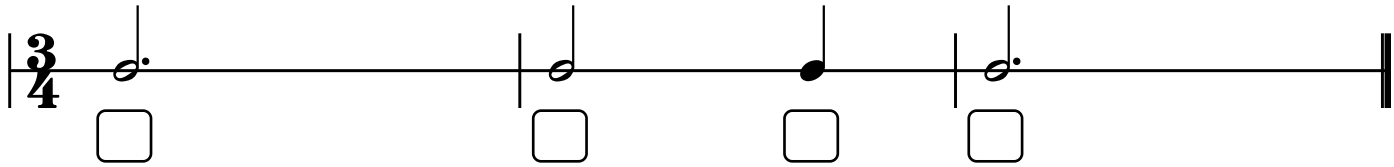
2



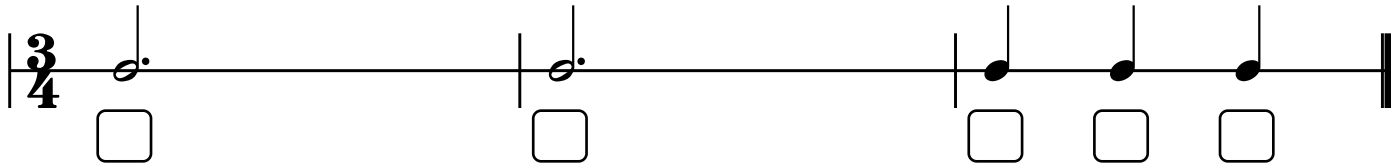
3



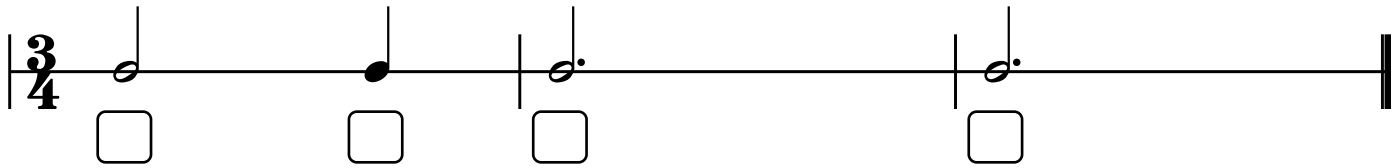
4



5



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 8

8. Dotted half notes in 4/4

Unit 3 · 4/4

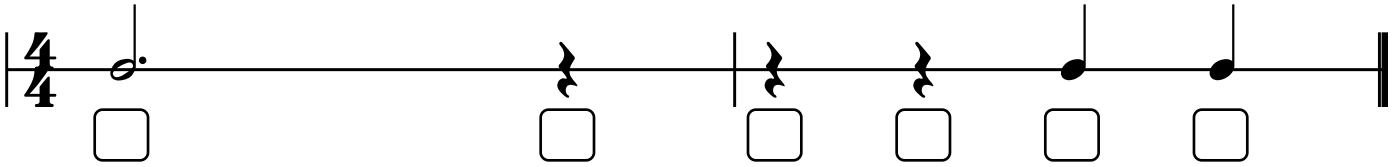
Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. A dotted half note lasts 3 beats. Count the beat that comes after it. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

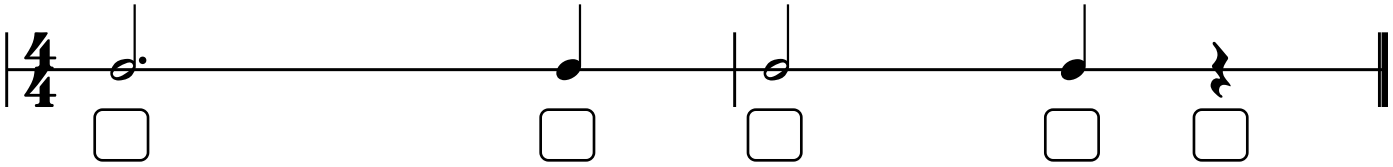
HALF NOTE	DOTTED HALF NOTE	QUARTER NOTE	QUARTER REST
2 beats	3 beats	1 beat	1 beat

Counts to use: 4/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &

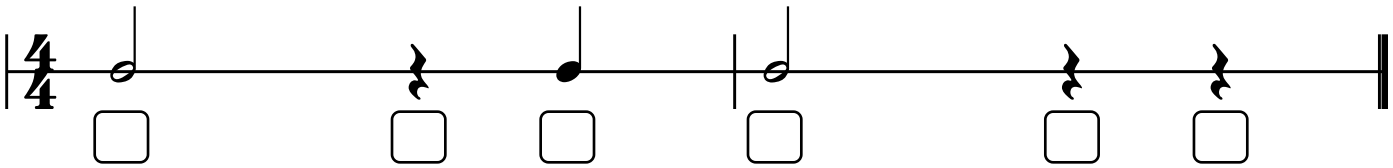
1



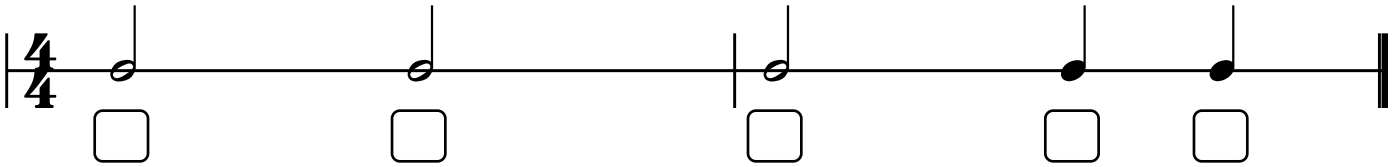
2



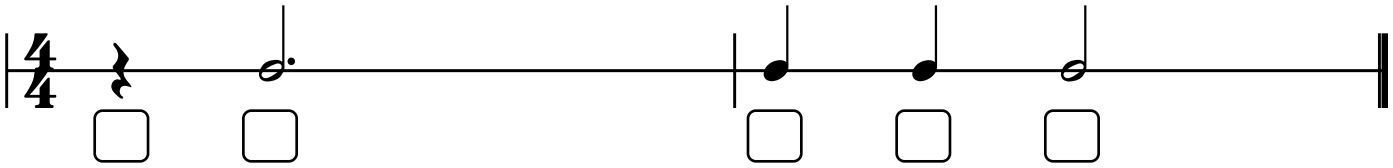
3



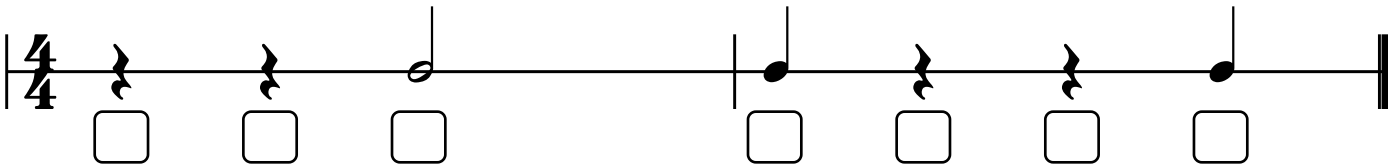
4



5



6



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RHYTHM COUNTING

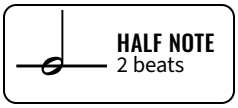
WORKSHEET 9

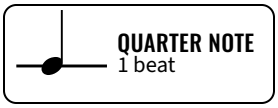
9. Eighth notes in 4/4

Unit 4 · 4/4

Name _____ Date _____

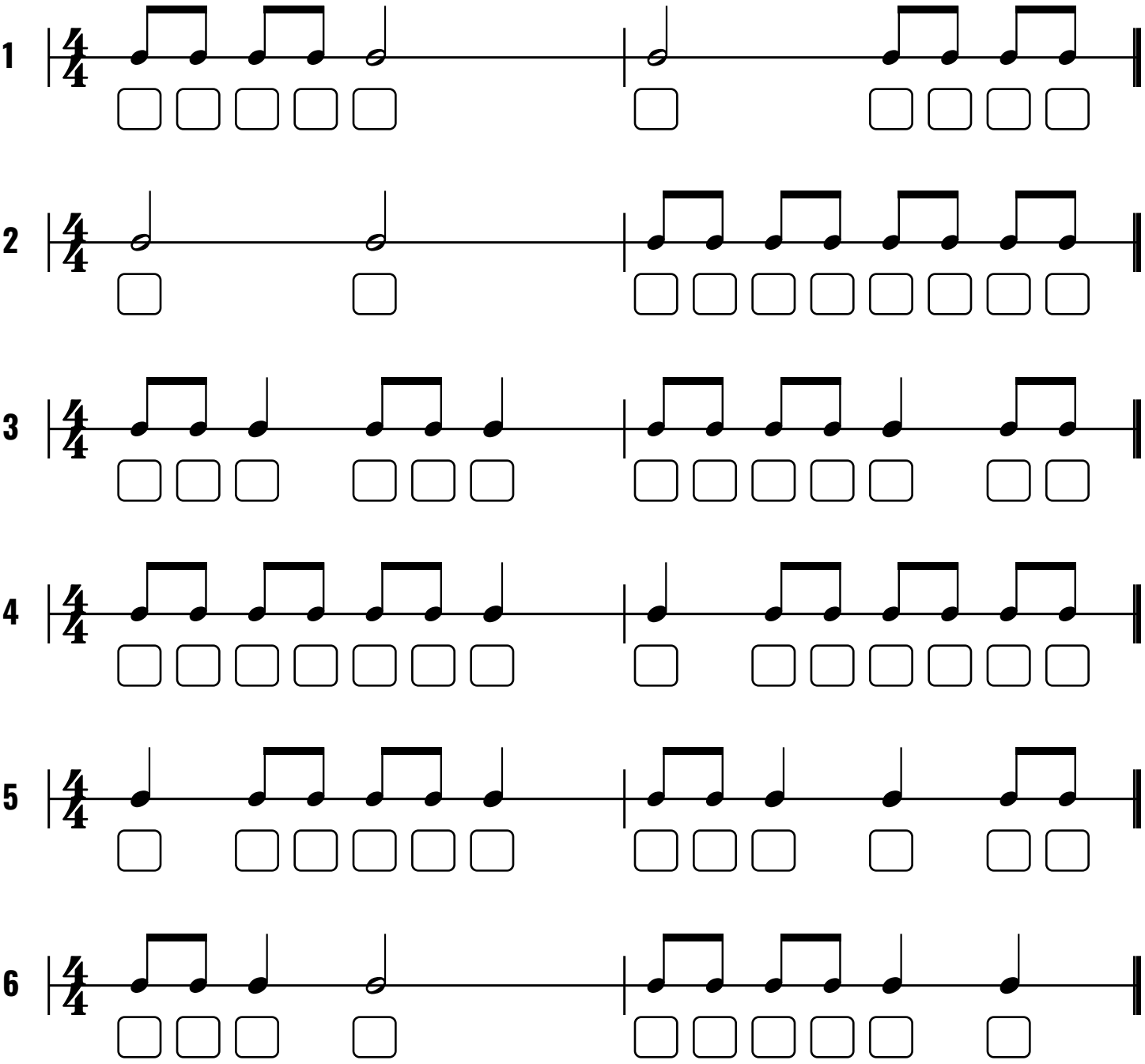
Write in the counts. Two eighth notes fill one beat: count them 1 & (one-and). Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.







Counts to use: 4/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 10

10. Eighth notes and quarter rests

Unit 4 · 4/4

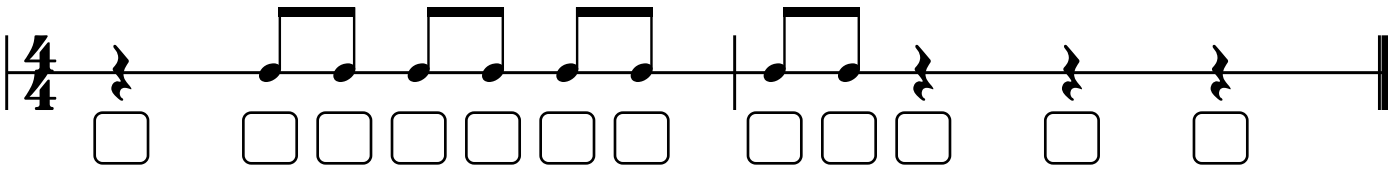
Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. Beamed eighth notes share a beam. Write 1 on the beat and & between beats. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

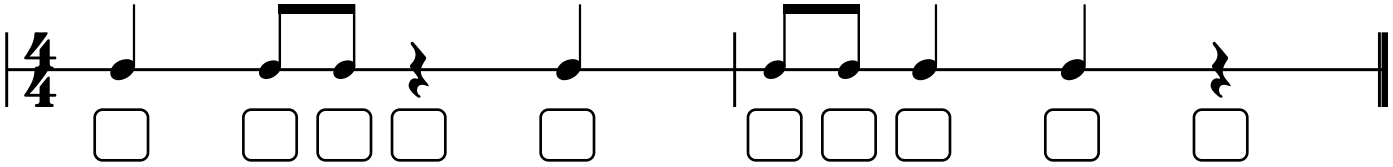
HALF NOTE	QUARTER NOTE	EIGHTH NOTE	QUARTER REST
2 beats	1 beat	½ beat	1 beat

Counts to use: 4/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &

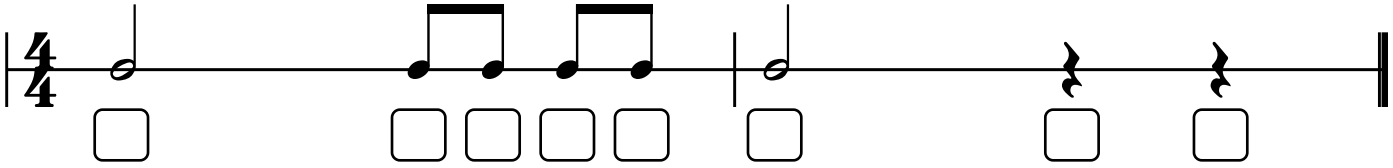
1



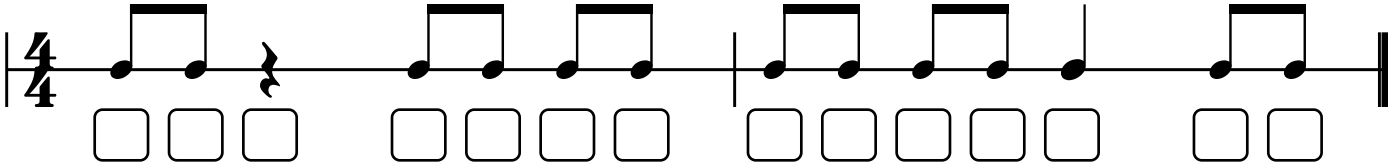
2



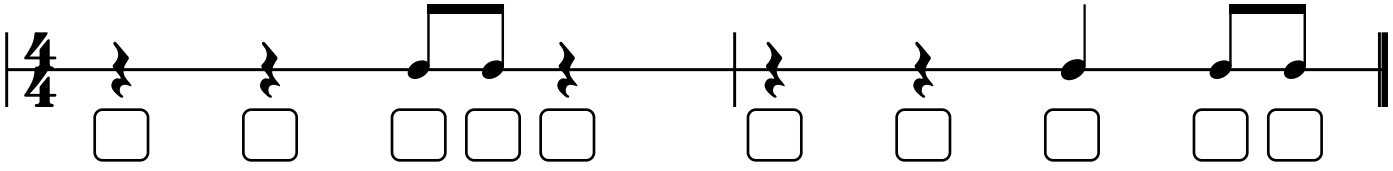
3



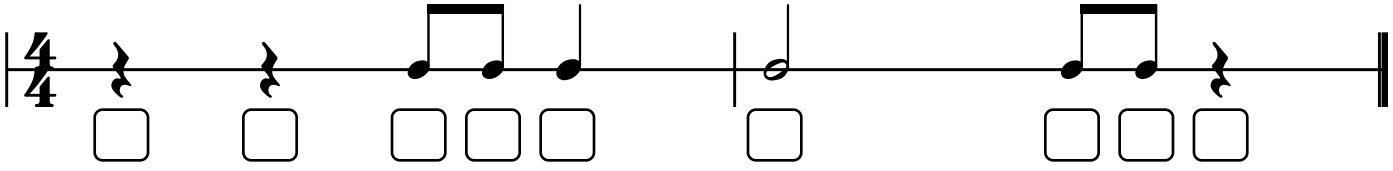
4



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 11

11. Eighth notes in 3/4

Unit 4 · 3/4

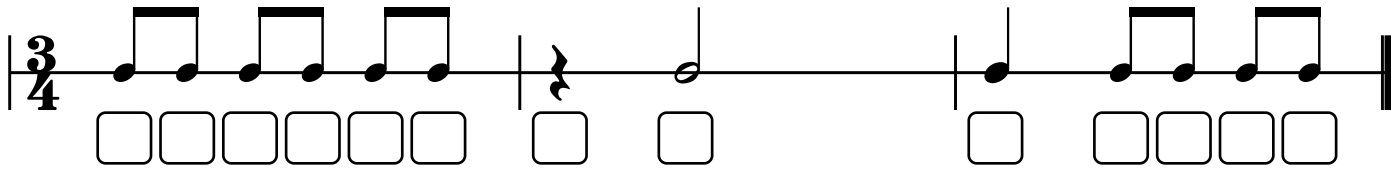
Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. Count eighth notes in 3/4 as 1 & 2 & 3 &. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

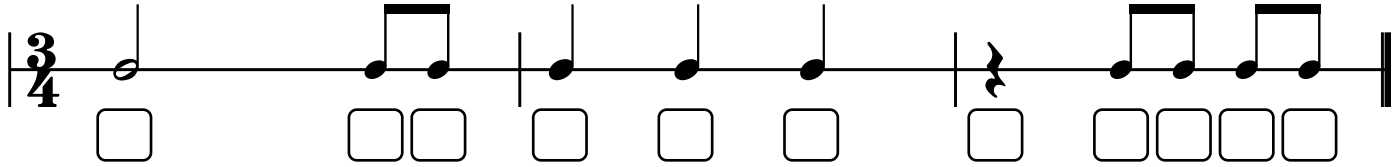
HALF NOTE	QUARTER NOTE	EIGHTH NOTE	QUARTER REST
2 beats	1 beat	½ beat	1 beat

Counts to use: 3/4: 1 & 2 & 3 &

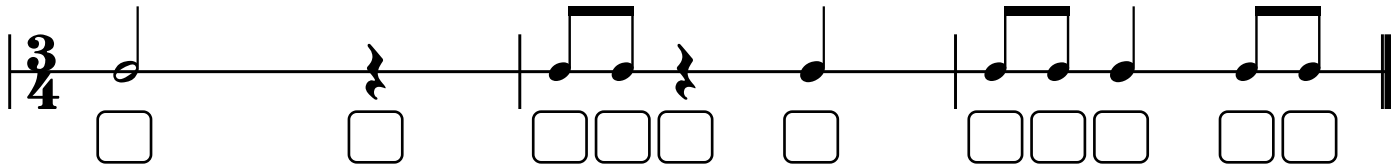
1



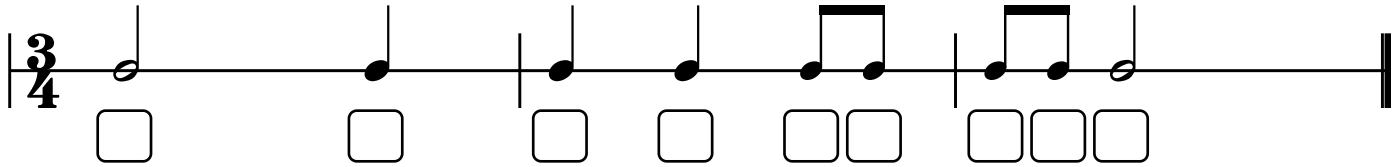
2



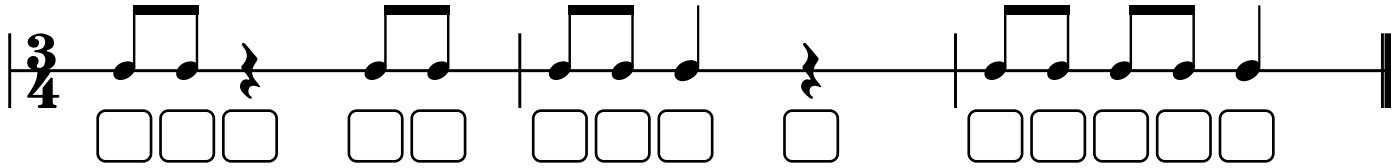
3



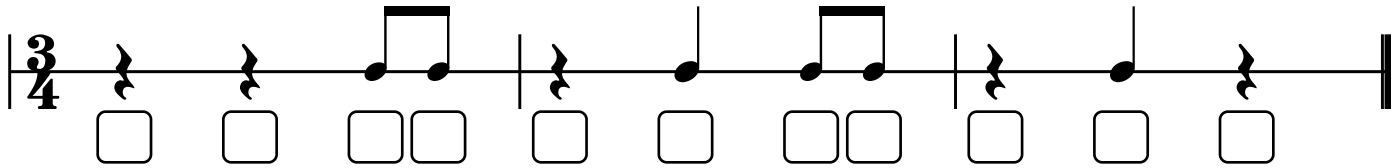
4



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 12

12. Eighth rests

Unit 4 · 4/4

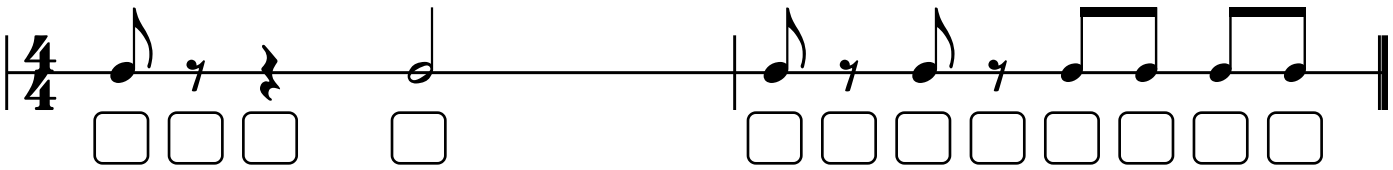
Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. An eighth rest is half a beat of silence. Count it like a note. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

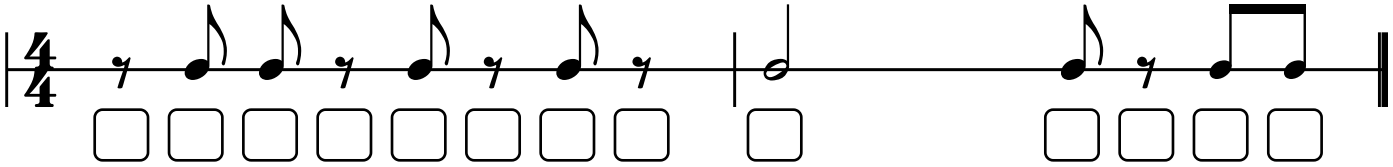
HALF NOTE	QUARTER NOTE	EIGHTH NOTE	QUARTER REST	EIGHTH REST
2 beats	1 beat	½ beat	1 beat	½ beat

Counts to use: 4/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &

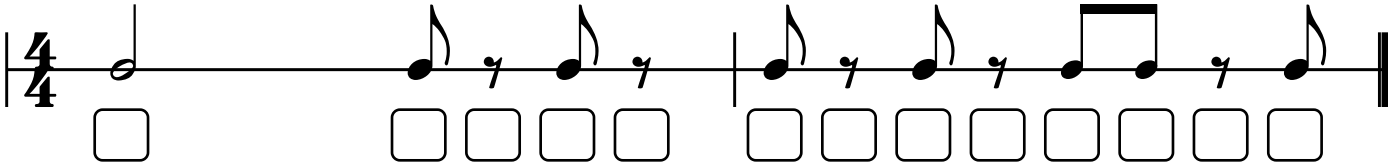
1



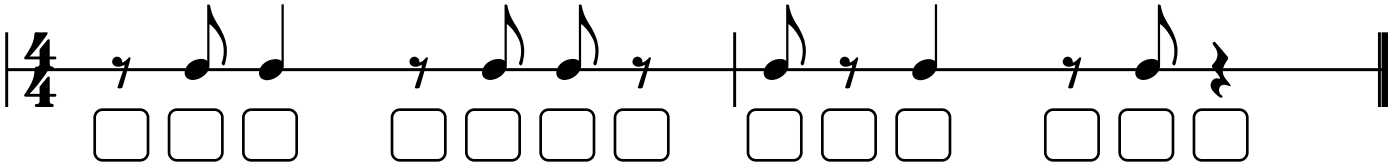
2



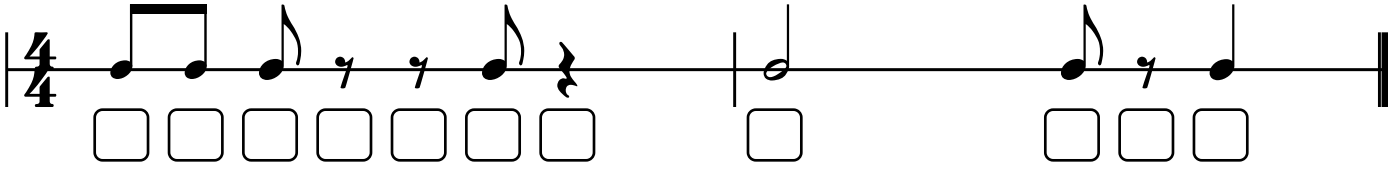
3



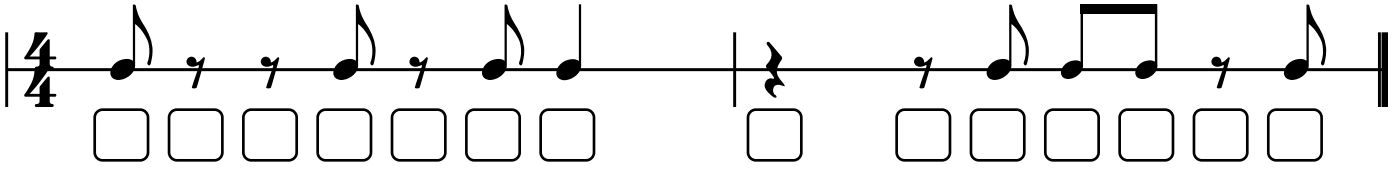
4



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 13

13. Dotted quarter and eighth

Unit 5 · 4/4

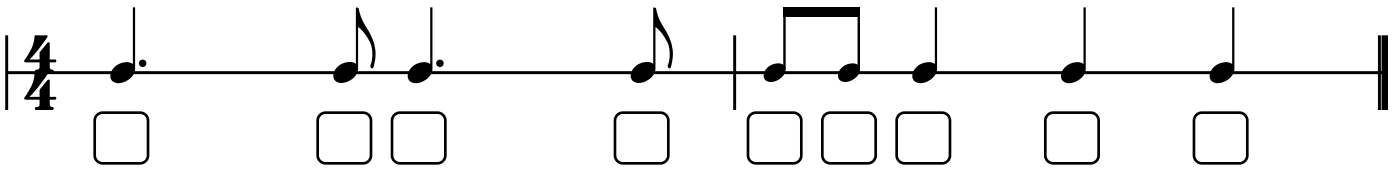
Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. A dotted quarter lasts 1½ beats. The eighth after it lands on the &. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

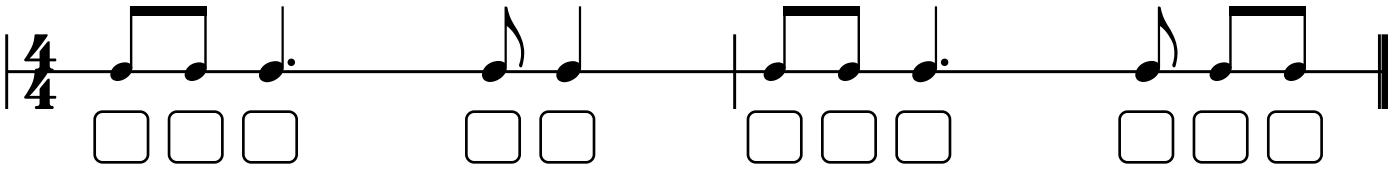
HALF NOTE	QUARTER NOTE	DOTTED QUARTER NOTE	EIGHTH NOTE
2 beats	1 beat	1½ beats	½ beat

Counts to use: 4/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &

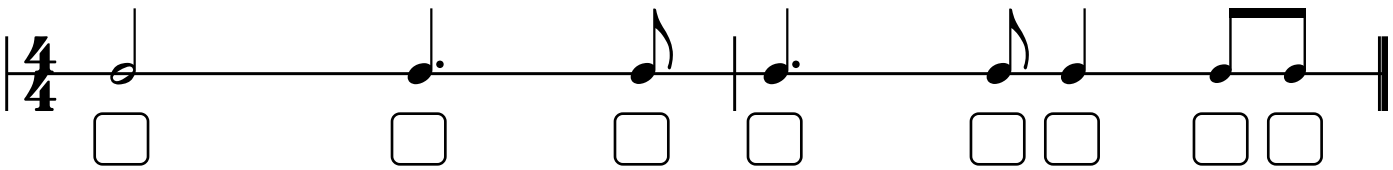
1



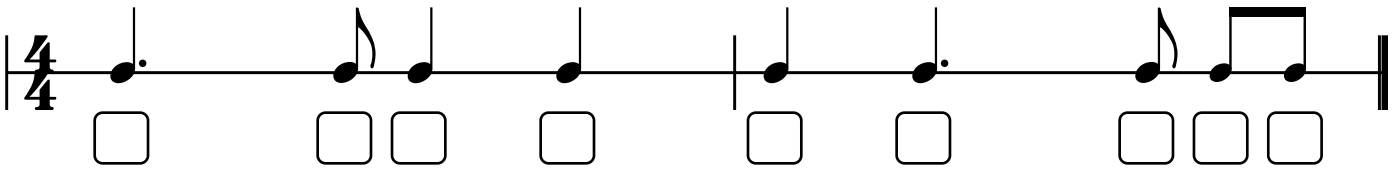
2



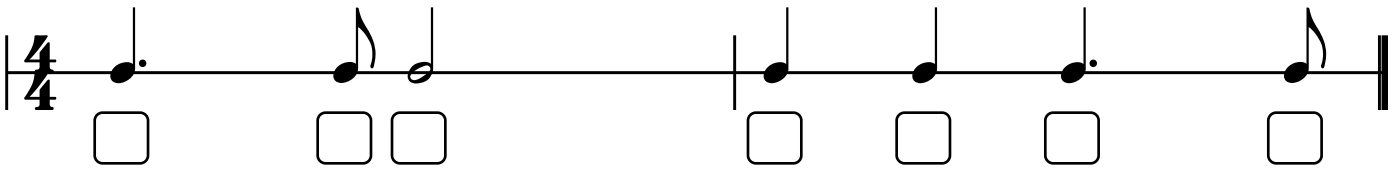
3



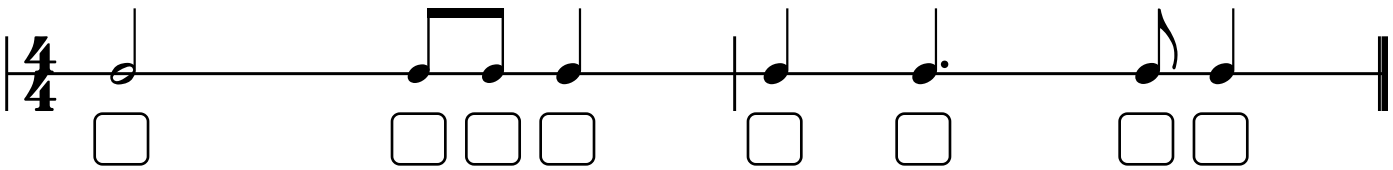
4



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RHYTHM COUNTING

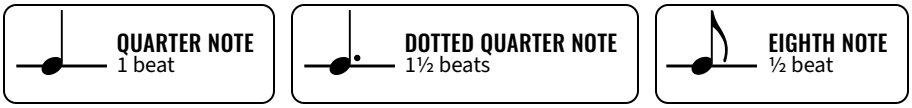
WORKSHEET 14

14. Dotted quarter and eighth in 2/4

Unit 5 · 2/4

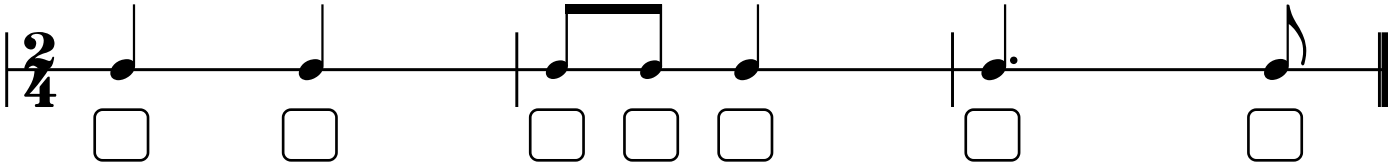
Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. In 2/4 one dotted quarter and eighth fill the whole measure. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

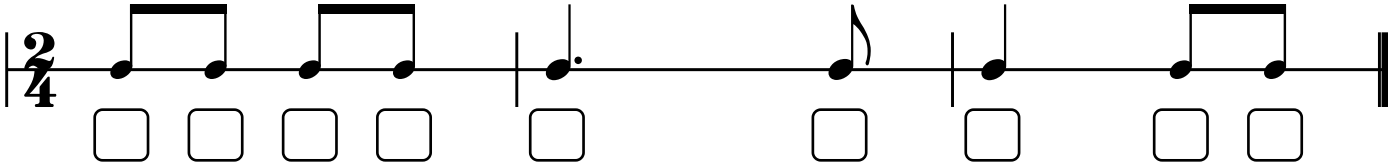


Counts to use: 2/4: 1 & 2 &

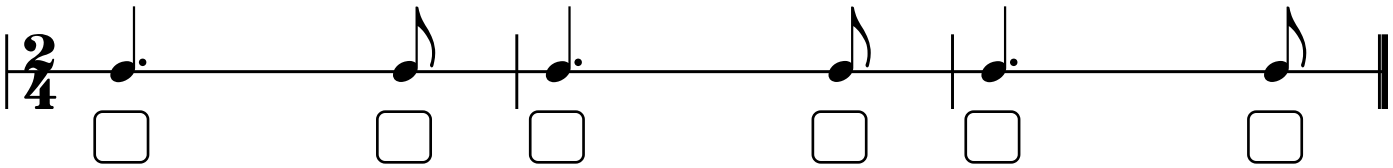
1



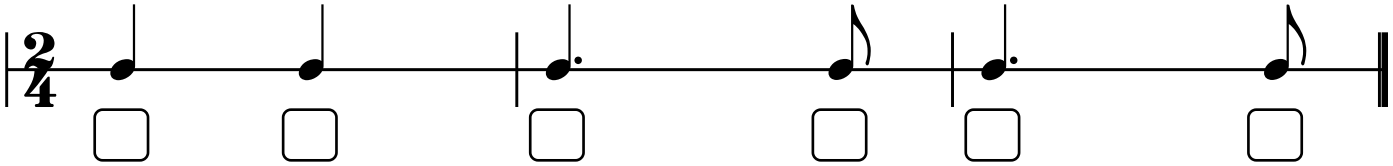
2



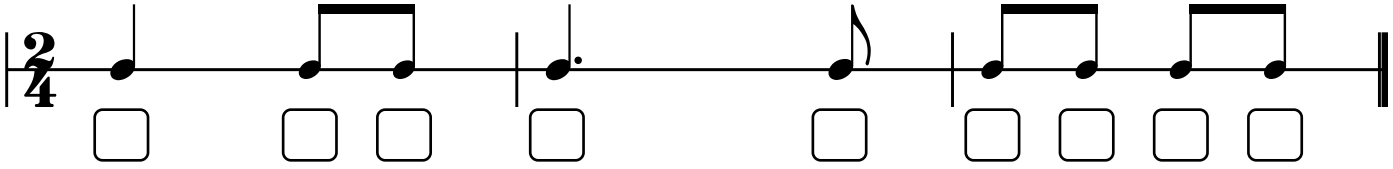
3



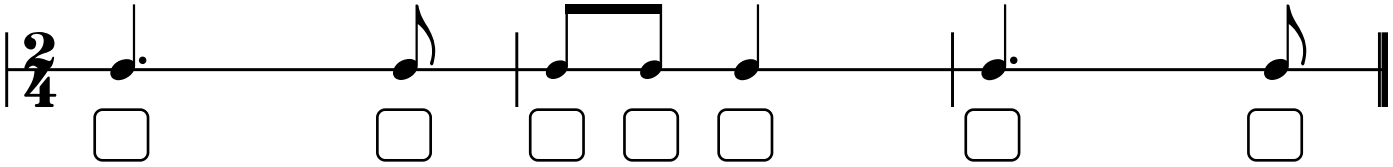
4



5



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RHYTHM COUNTING

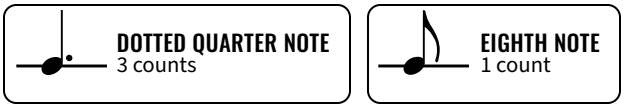
WORKSHEET 15

15. Six-eight time: first steps

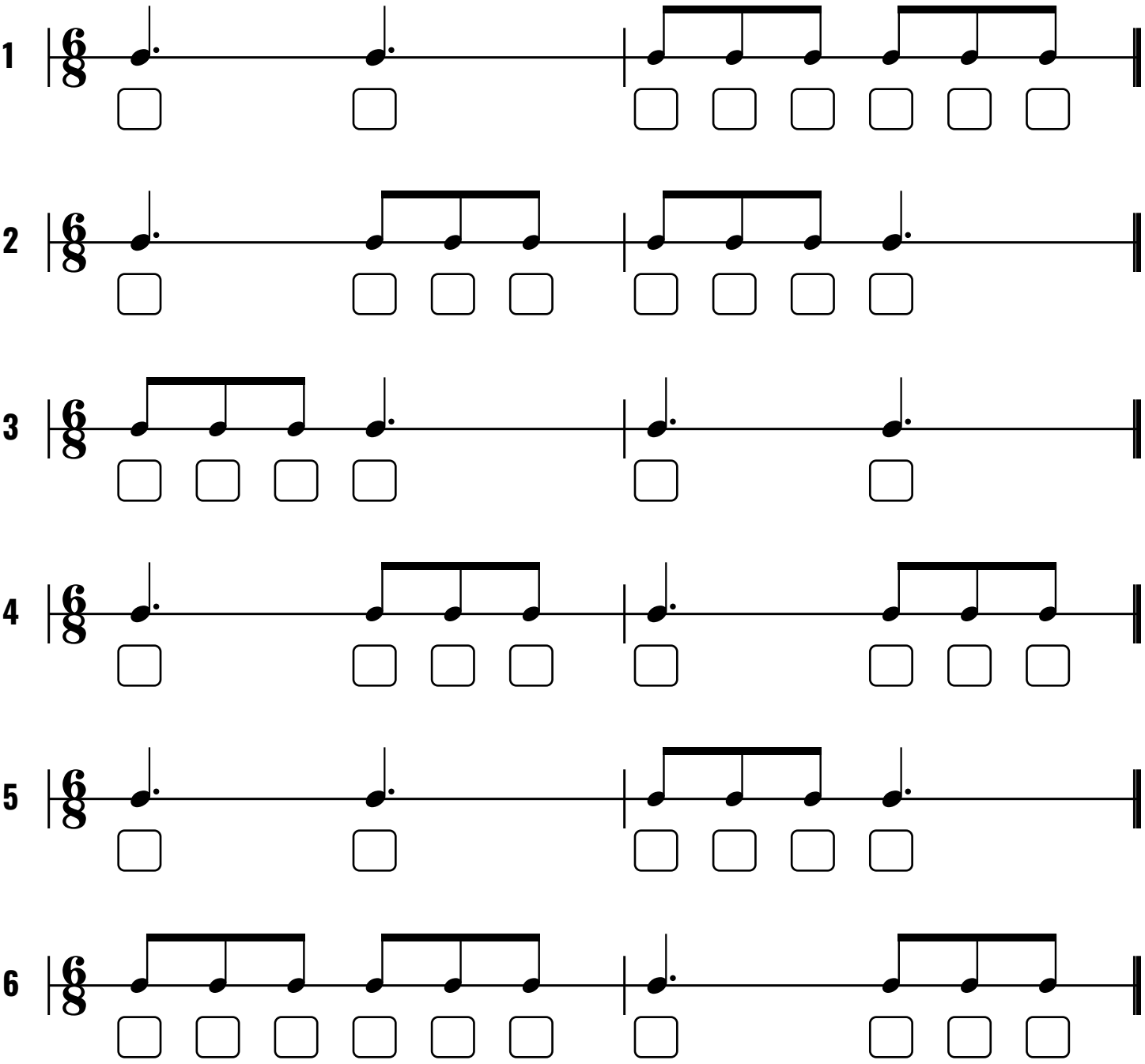
Unit 6 · 6/8

Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. In 6/8 there are 6 counts in every measure. The eighth note gets one count. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.



Counts to use: 6/8: 1 2 3 4 5 6



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 16

16. Six-eight time: quarters and eighths

Unit 6 · 6/8

Name _____ Date _____

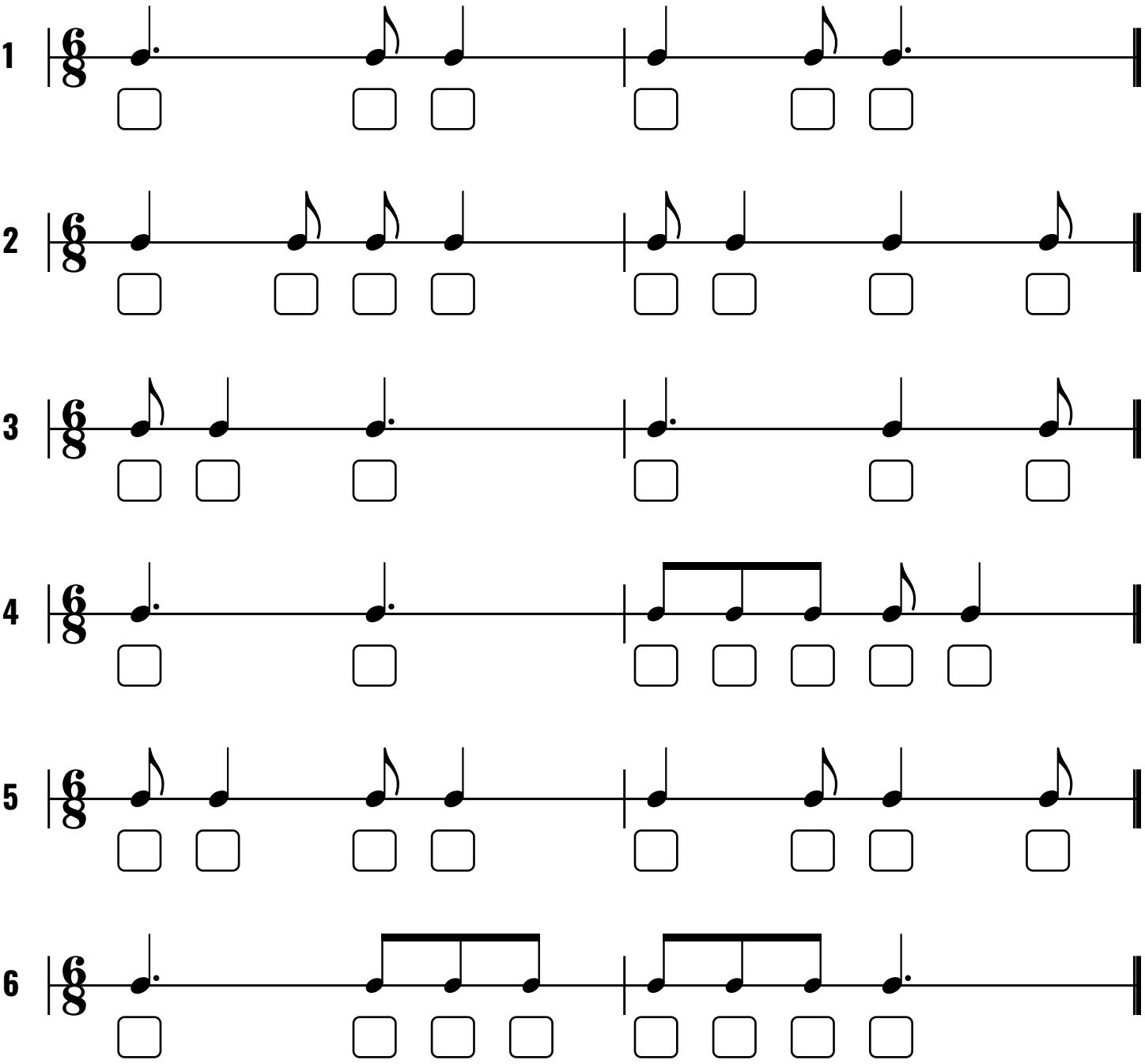
Write in the counts. In 6/8 a quarter note is 2 counts and a dotted quarter is 3 counts. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.







Counts to use: 6/8: 1 2 3 4 5 6



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RHYTHM COUNTING

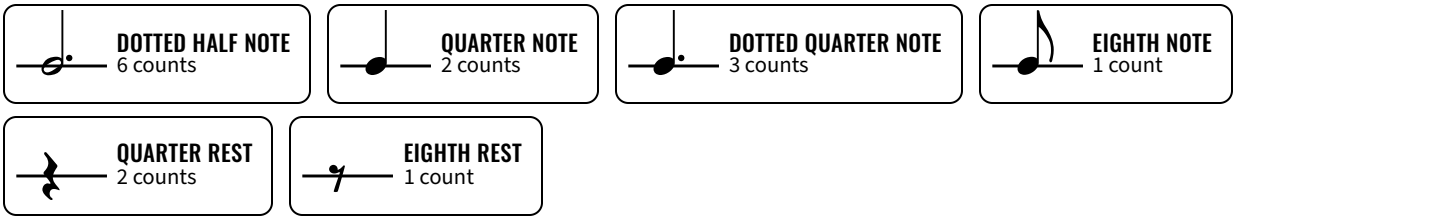
WORKSHEET 17

17. Six-eight time: rests and dotted half

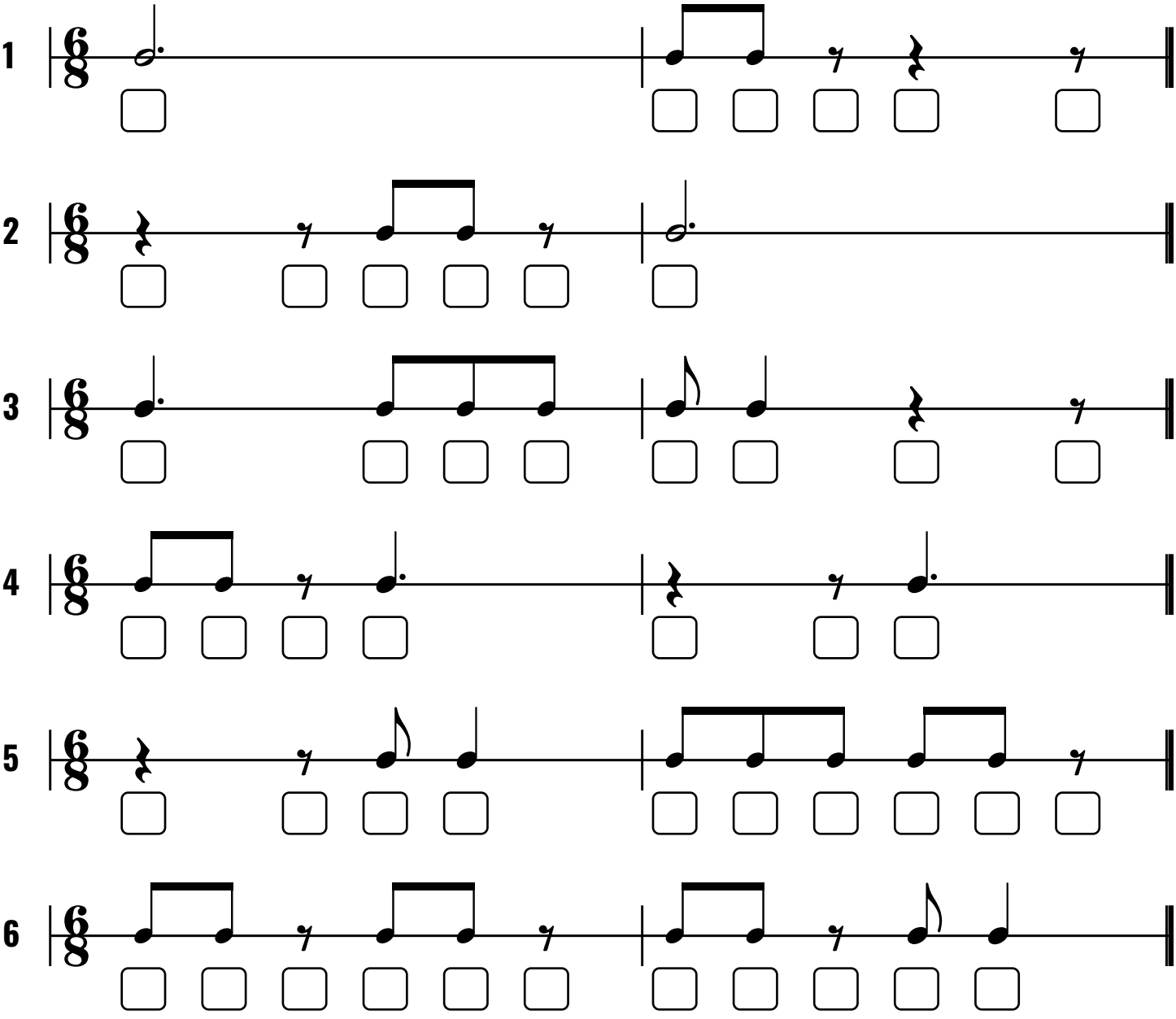
Unit 6 · 6/8

Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. A dotted half note is 6 counts in 6/8: a whole measure. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.



Counts to use: 6/8: 1 2 3 4 5 6



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 18

18. Review: 4/4, 3/4 and 2/4

Unit 7 · 4/4 · 3/4 · 2/4

Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. Check the time signature first, then count each measure. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

HALF NOTE 2 beats

DOTTED HALF NOTE 3 beats

QUARTER NOTE 1 beat

EIGHTH NOTE ½ beat

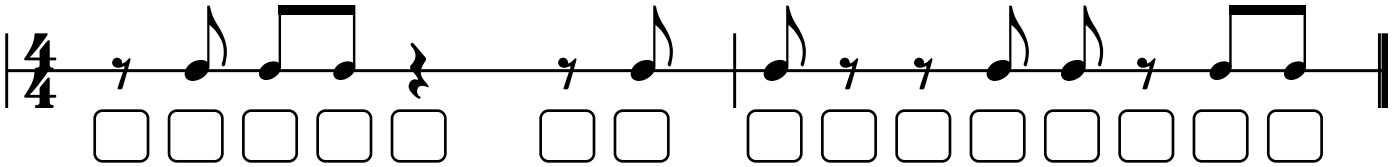
HALF REST 2 beats

QUARTER REST 1 beat

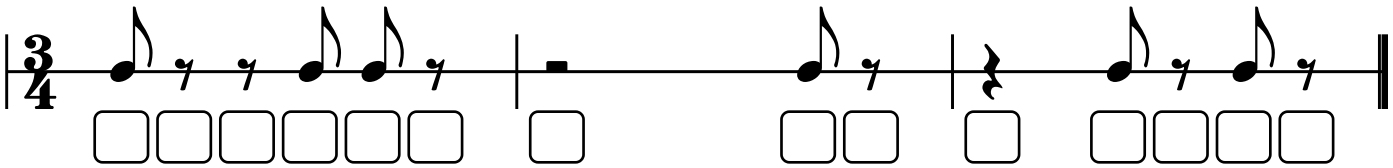
EIGHTH REST ½ beat

Counts to use: 4/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & · 3/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & · 2/4: 1 & 2 &

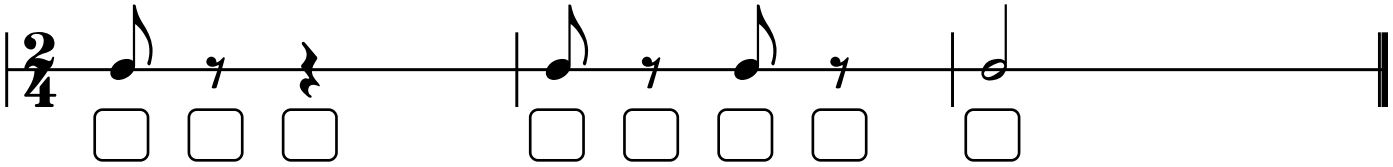
1



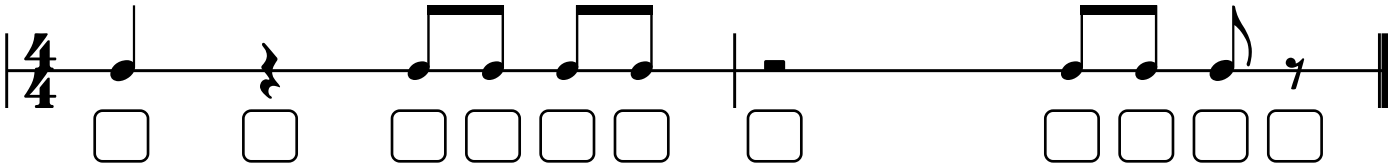
2



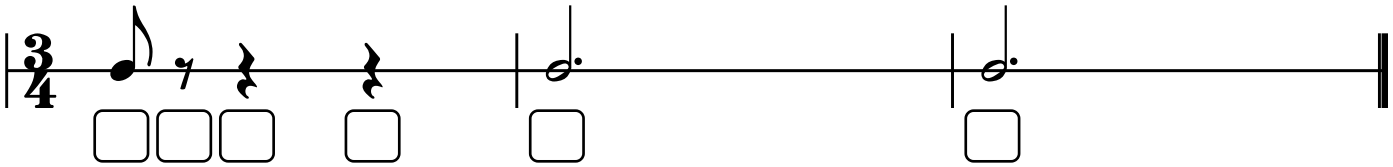
3



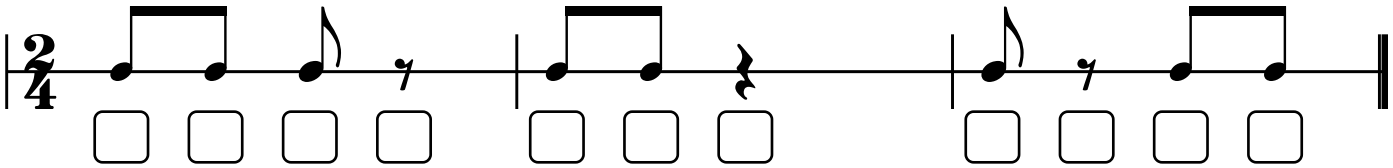
4



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 19

19. Review: dotted rhythms and eighths

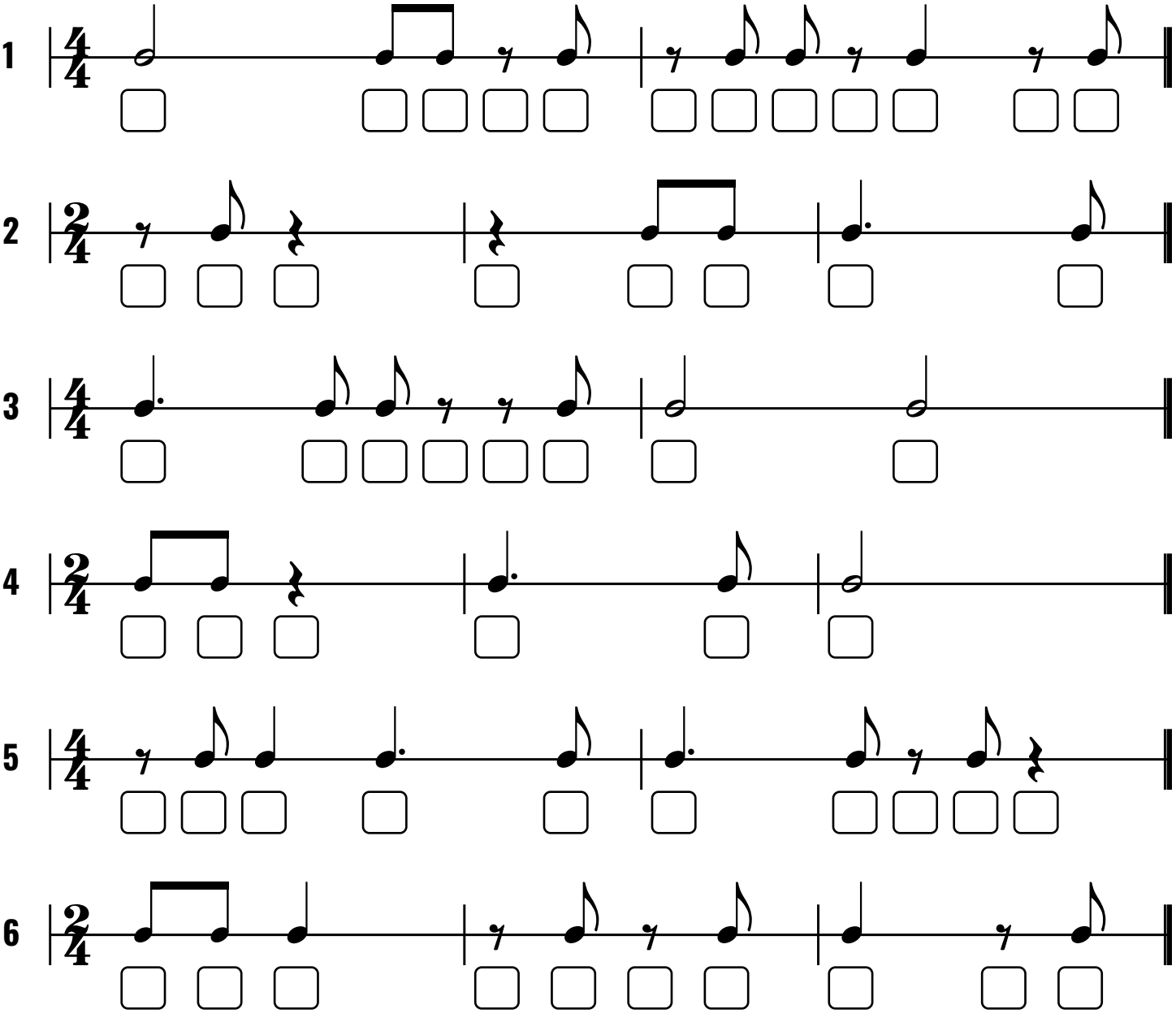
Unit 7 · 4/4 · 2/4

Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. Dotted quarter and eighth patterns, with rests. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

HALF NOTE 2 beats	**QUARTER NOTE** 1 beat	**DOTTED QUARTER NOTE** 1½ beats	**EIGHTH NOTE** ½ beat
QUARTER REST 1 beat	**EIGHTH REST** ½ beat		

Counts to use: 4/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & · 2/4: 1 & 2 &



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RHYTHM COUNTING

WORKSHEET 20

20. Challenge: all the meters

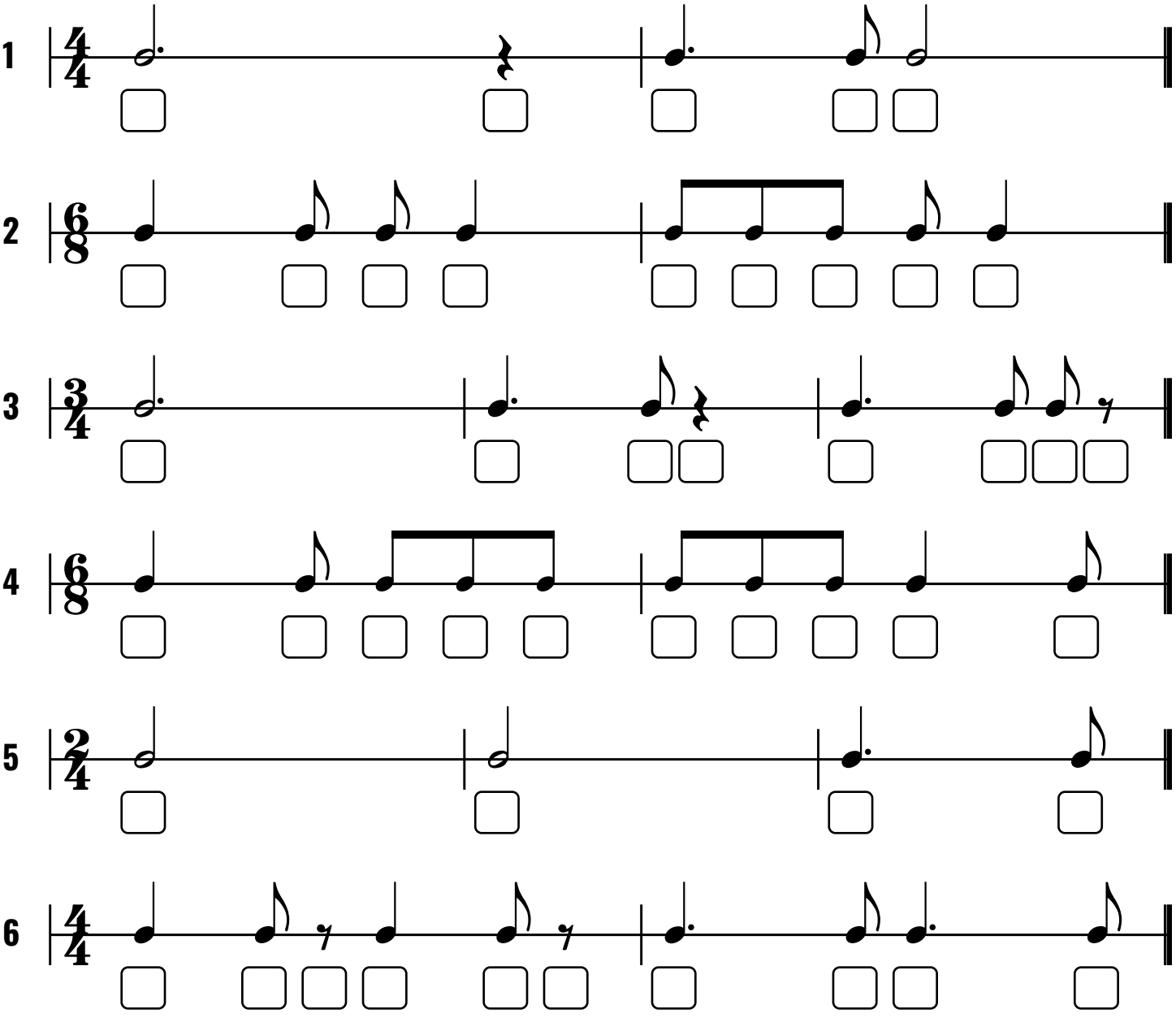
Unit 7 · 4/4 · 6/8 · 3/4 · 2/4

Name _____ Date _____

Write in the counts. Every meter and every rhythm in this book. Read the time signature of each line. Write the count in the box under each note or rest, at the place where it begins.

HALF NOTE 2 beats	**DOTTED HALF NOTE** 3 beats	**QUARTER NOTE** 1 beat · 2 counts in 6/8	**DOTTED QUARTER NOTE** 1½ beats
EIGHTH NOTE ½ beat · 1 count in 6/8	**QUARTER REST** 1 beat	**EIGHTH REST** ½ beat	

Counts to use: 4/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & · 6/8: 1 2 3 4 5 6 · 3/4: 1 & 2 & 3 & · 2/4: 1 & 2 &



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ANSWER KEY

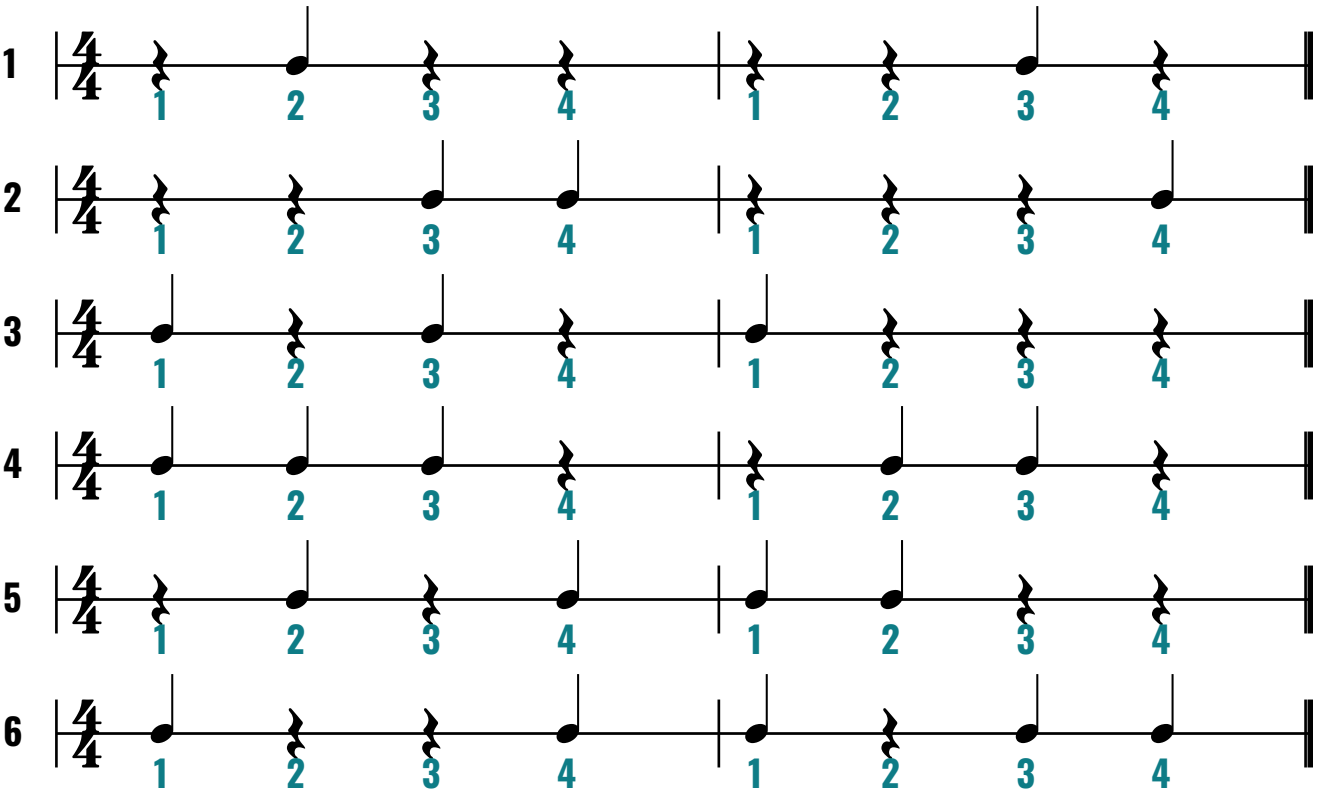
Worksheets 1 and 2

ANSWER KEY

Counts are written where each note begins

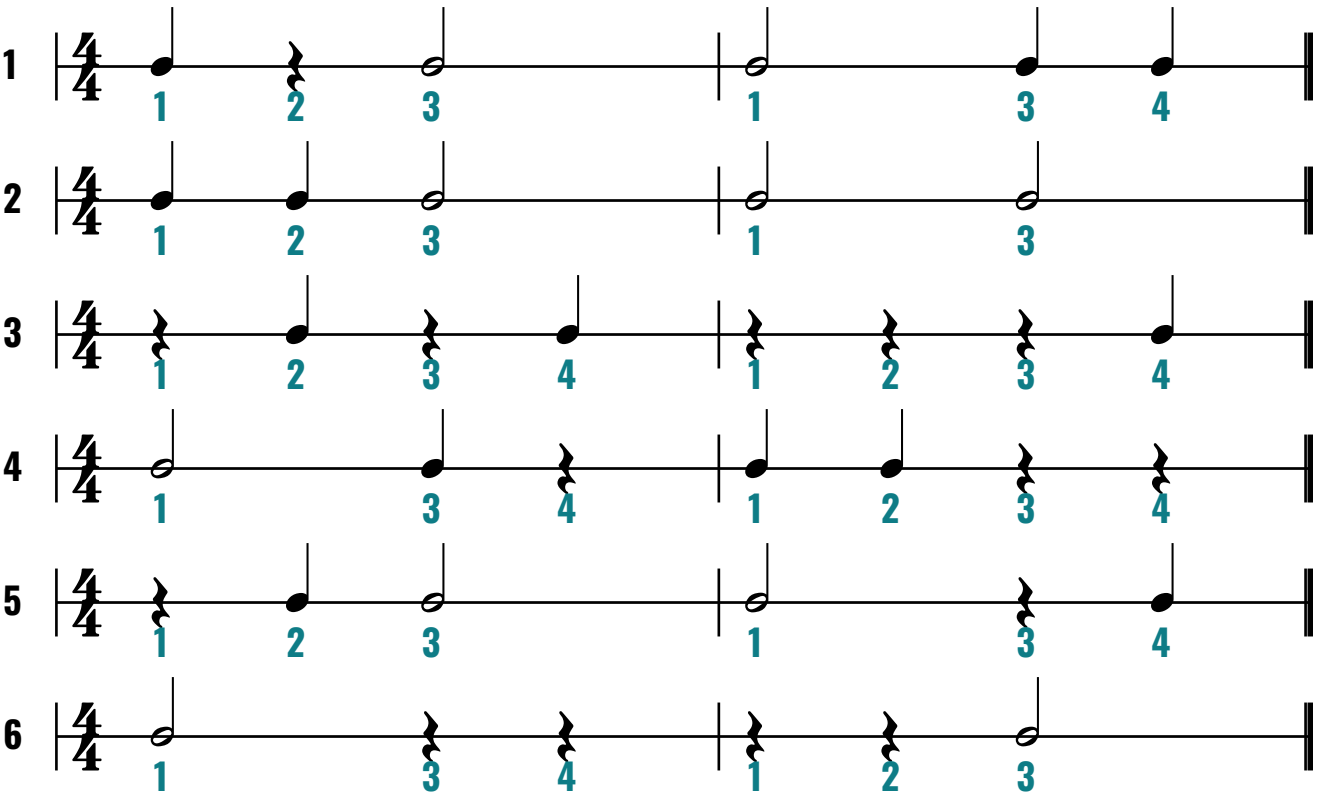
WORKSHEET 1 · Quarter notes and quarter rests

page 4



WORKSHEET 2 · Half notes

page 5



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ANSWER KEY

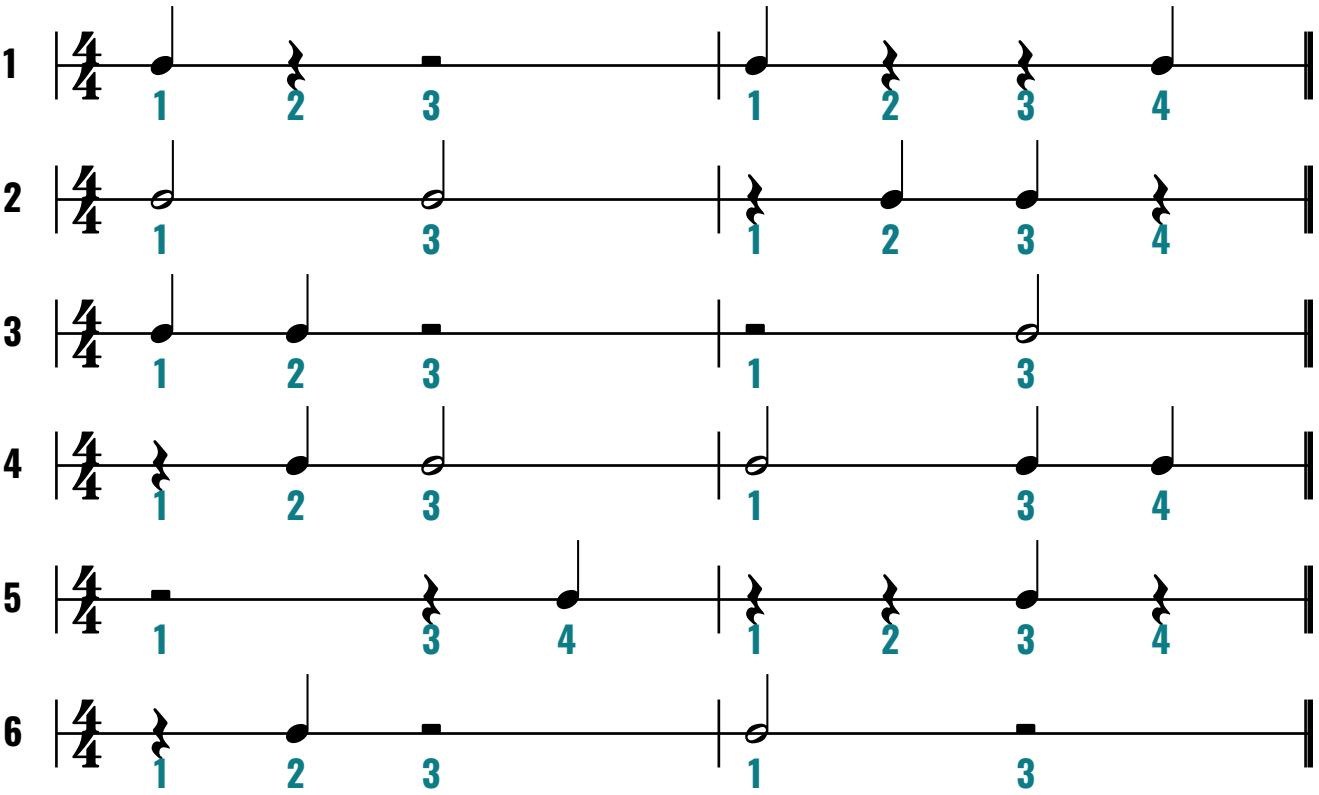
Worksheets 3 and 4

ANSWER KEY

Counts are written where each note begins

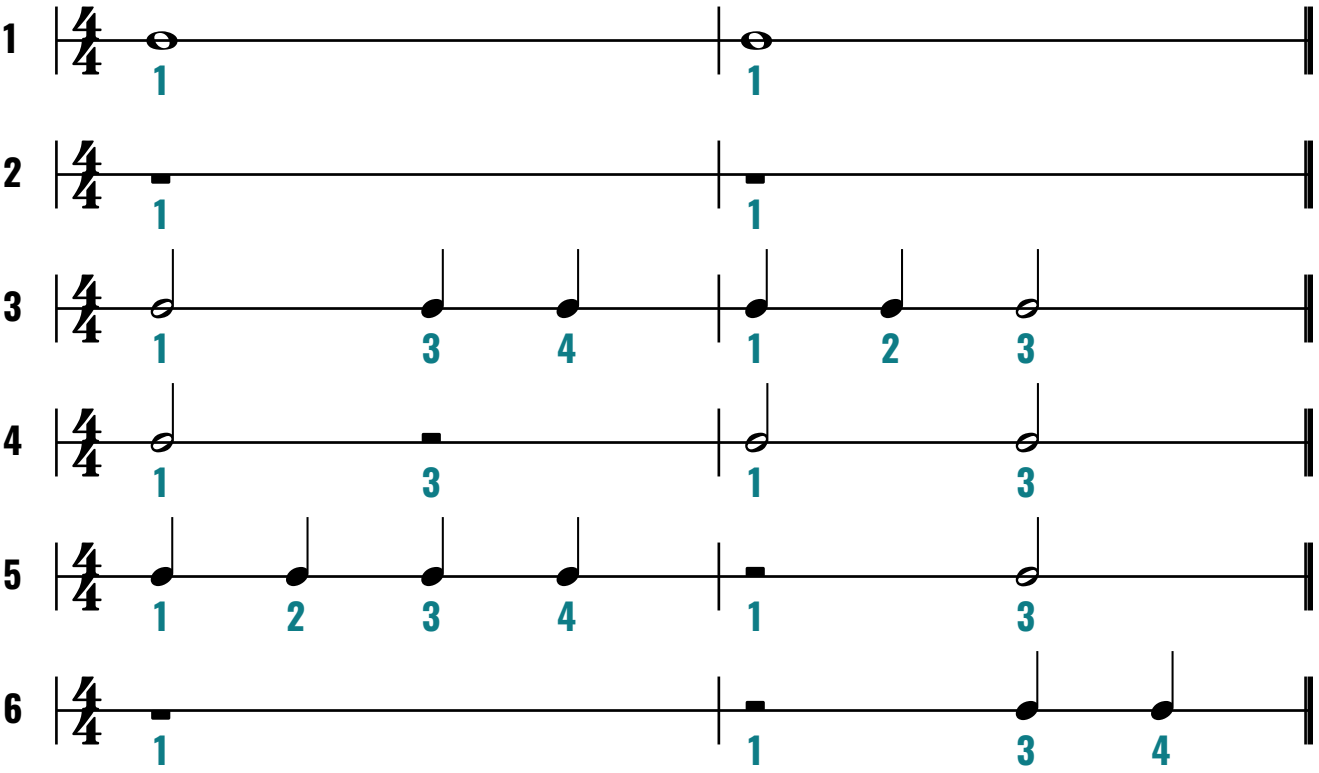
WORKSHEET 3 · Half rests

page 6



WORKSHEET 4 · Whole notes and whole rests

page 7



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ANSWER KEY

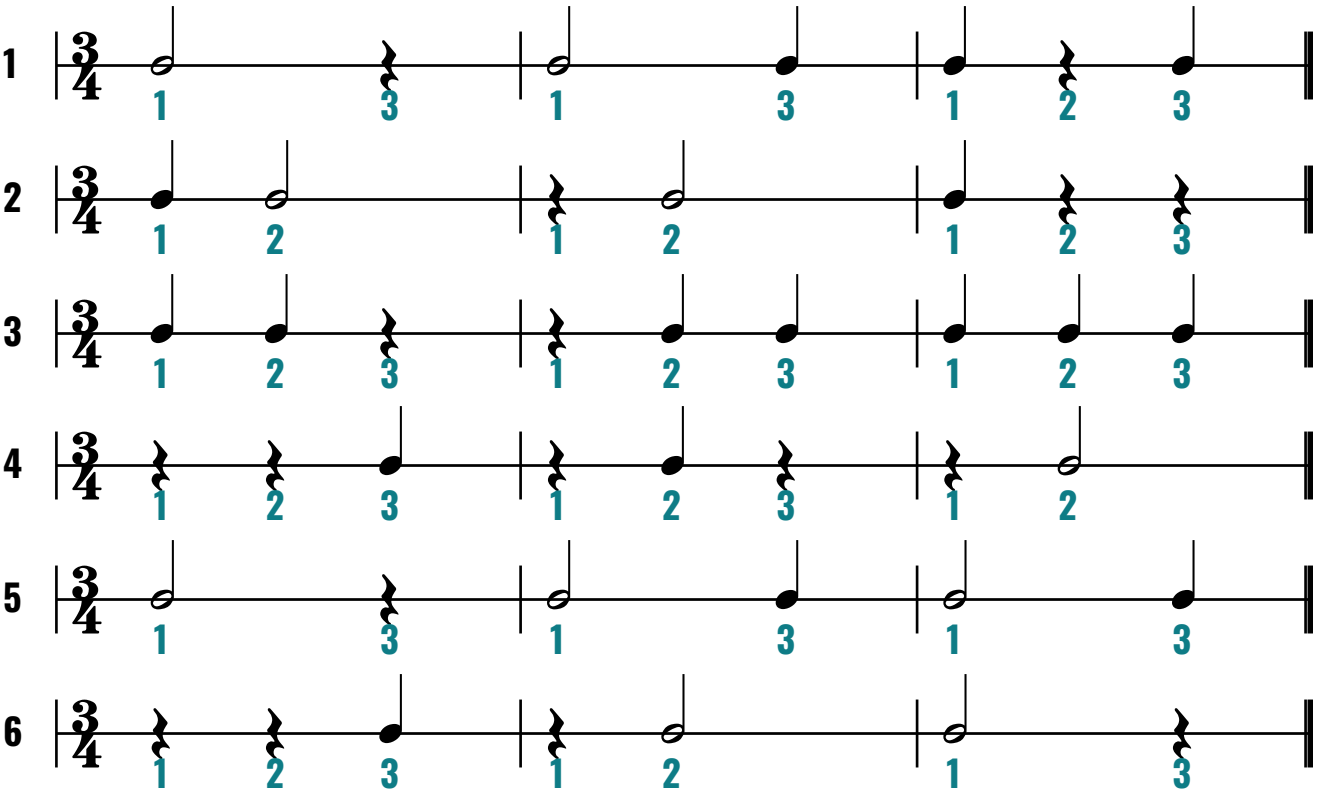
Worksheets 5 and 6

ANSWER KEY

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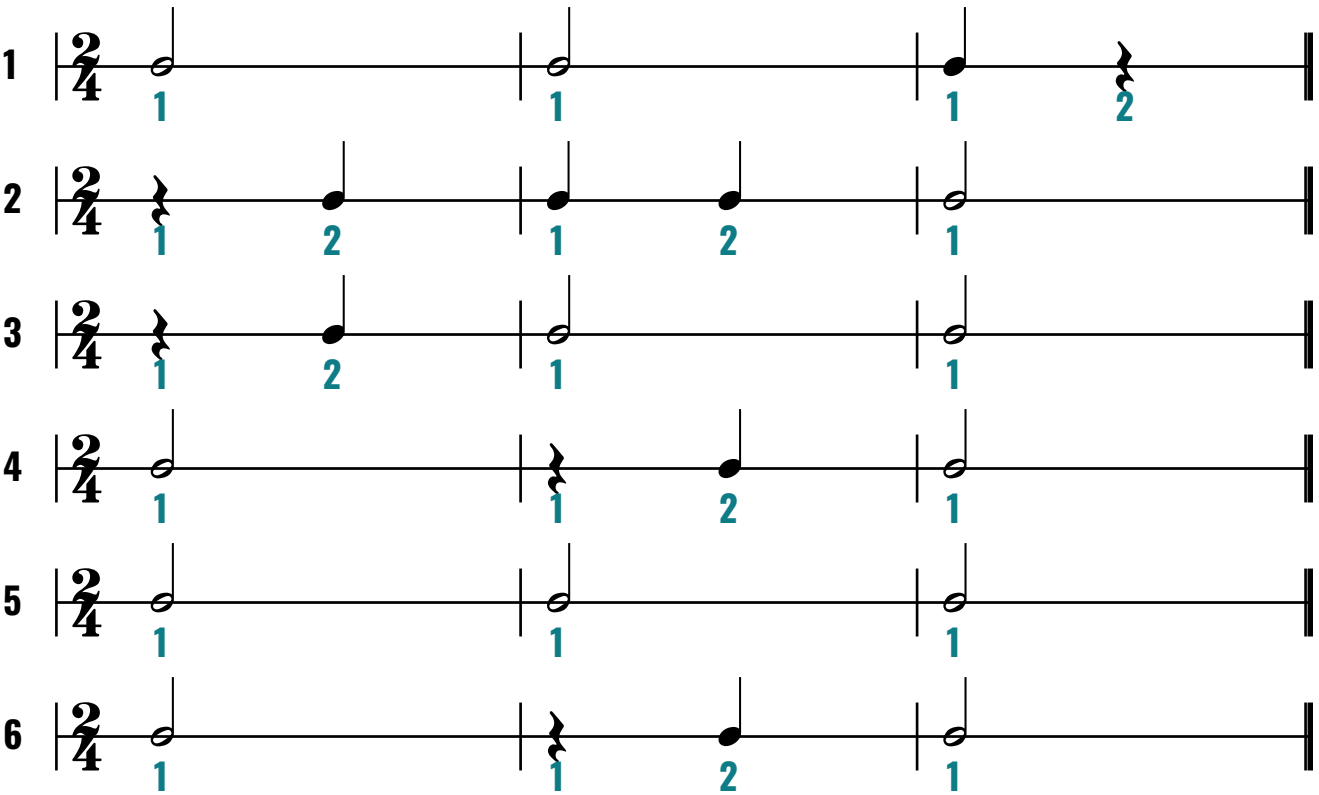
WORKSHEET 5 · Three-four time

page 8



WORKSHEET 6 · Two-four time

page 9



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ANSWER KEY

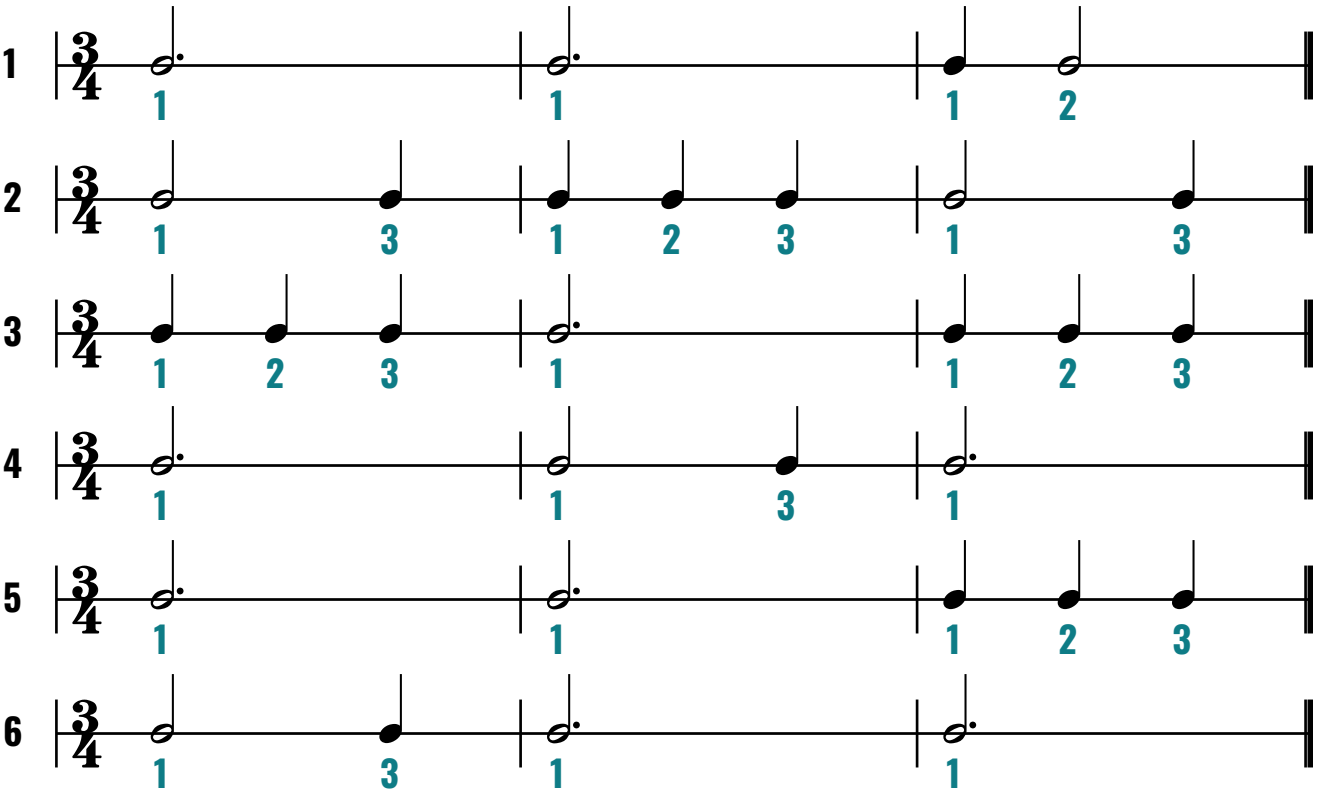
Worksheets 7 and 8

ANSWER KEY

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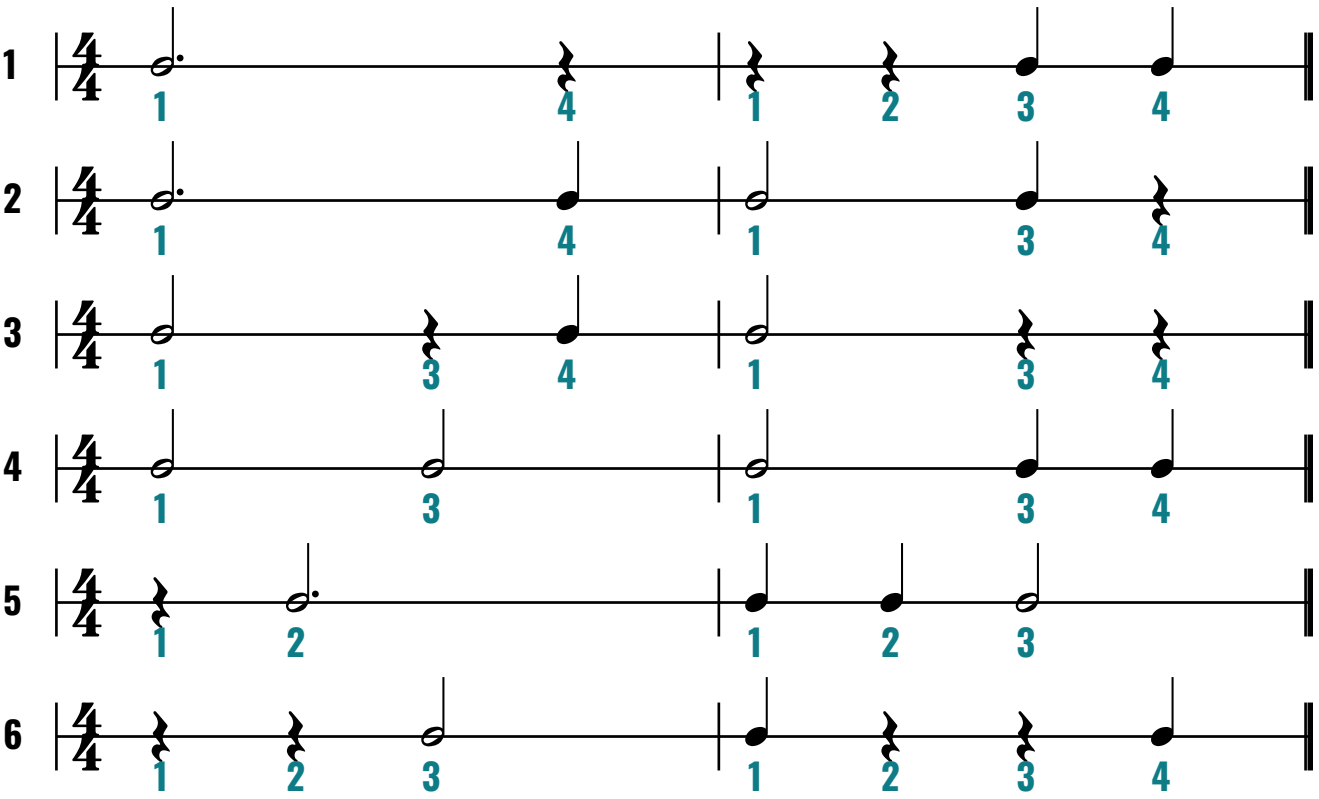
WORKSHEET 7 · Dotted half notes in 3/4

page 10



WORKSHEET 8 · Dotted half notes in 4/4

page 11



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ANSWER KEY

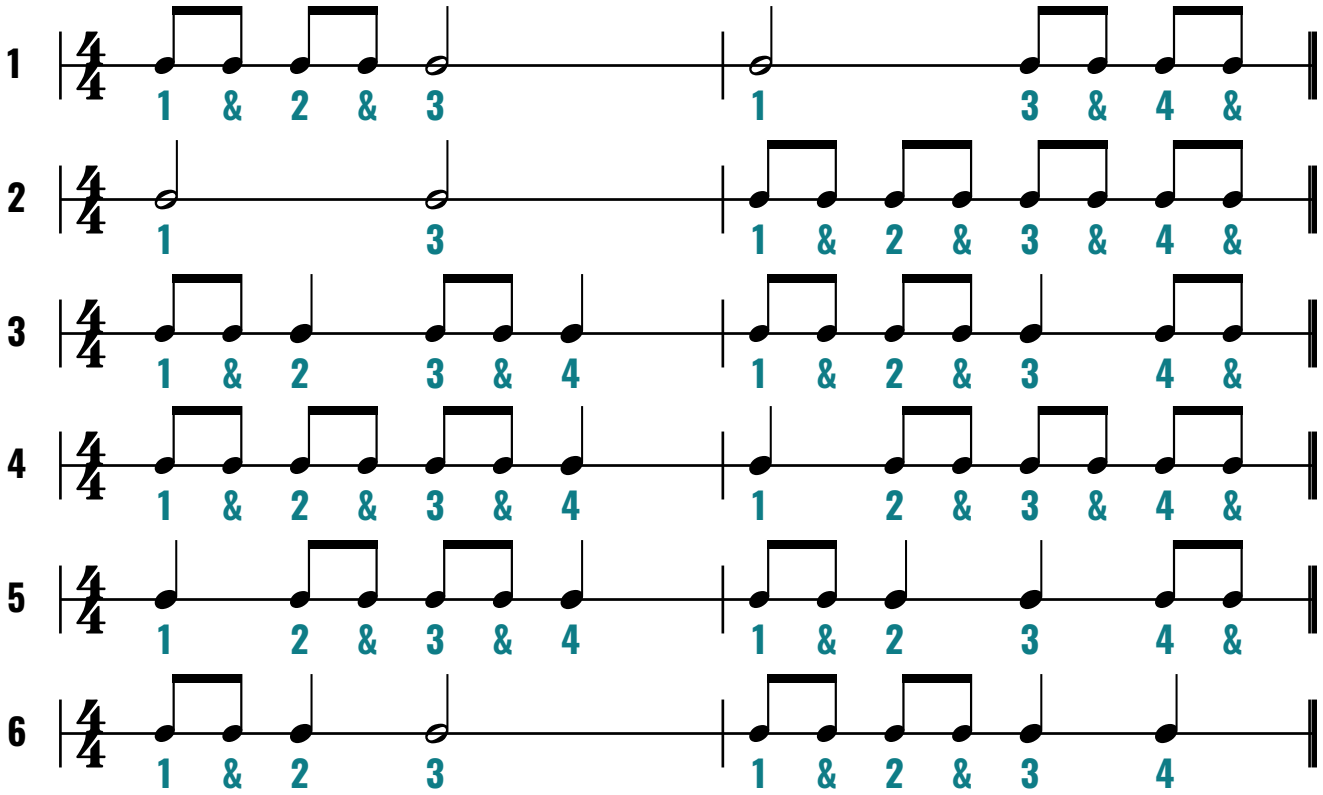
Worksheets 9 and 10

ANSWER KEY

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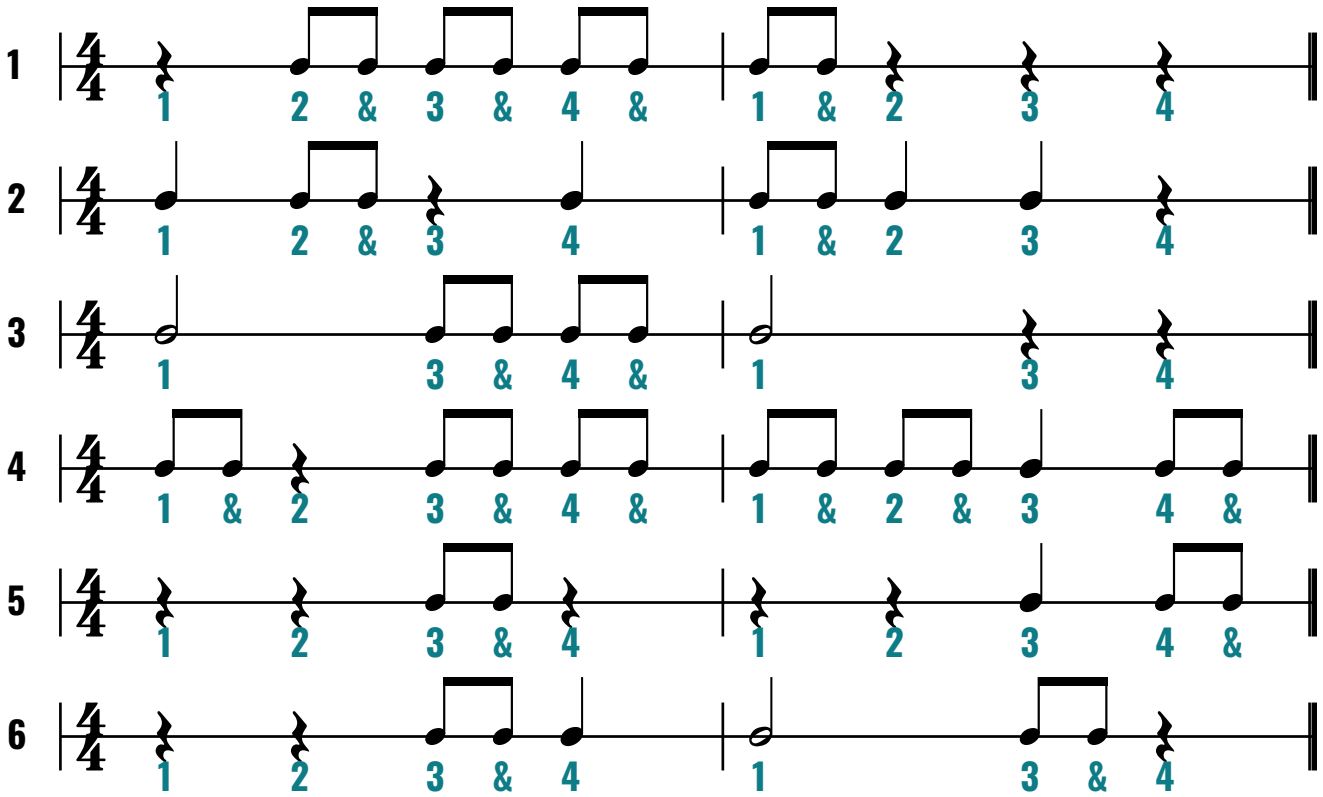
WORKSHEET 9 · Eighth notes in 4/4

page 12



WORKSHEET 10 · Eighth notes and quarter rests

page 13



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ANSWER KEY

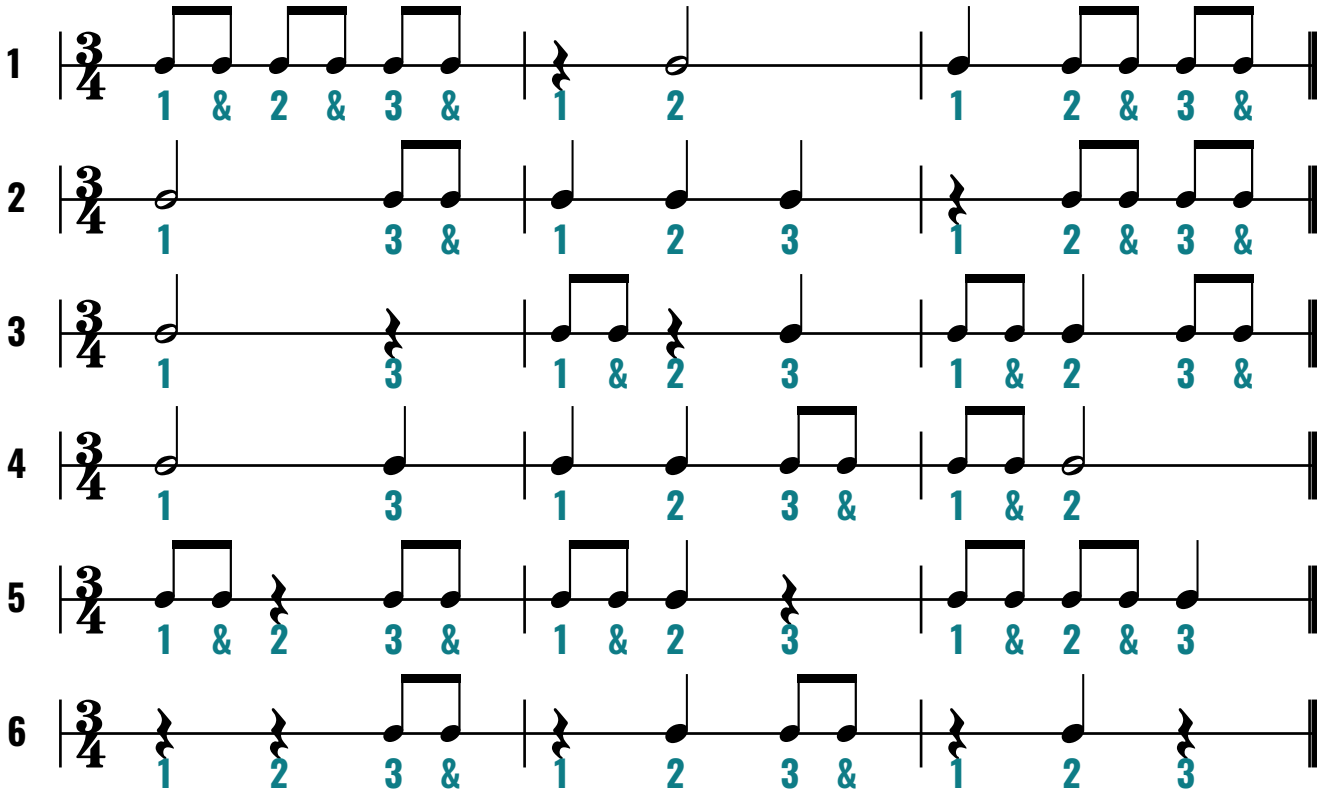
Worksheets 11 and 12

ANSWER KEY

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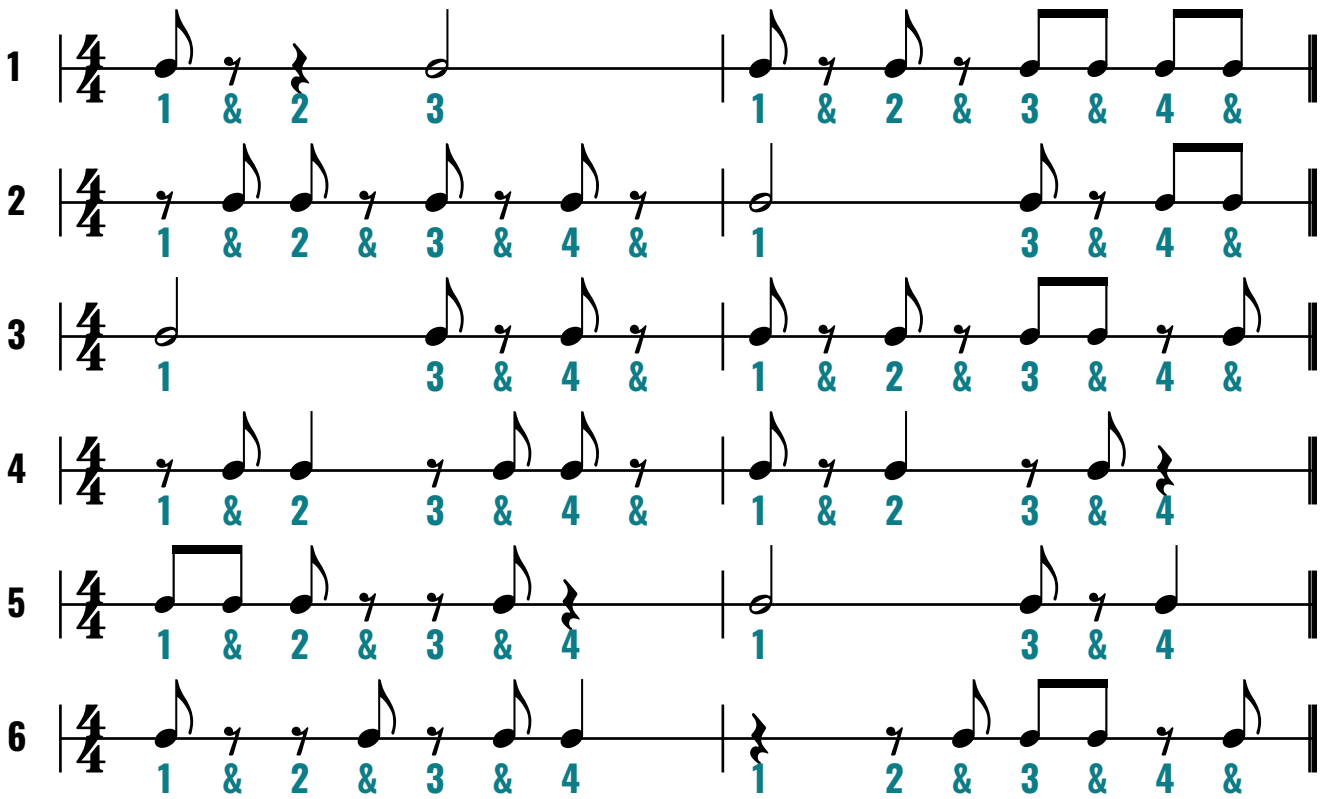
WORKSHEET 11 · Eighth notes in 3/4

page 14



WORKSHEET 12 · Eighth rests

page 15



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ANSWER KEY

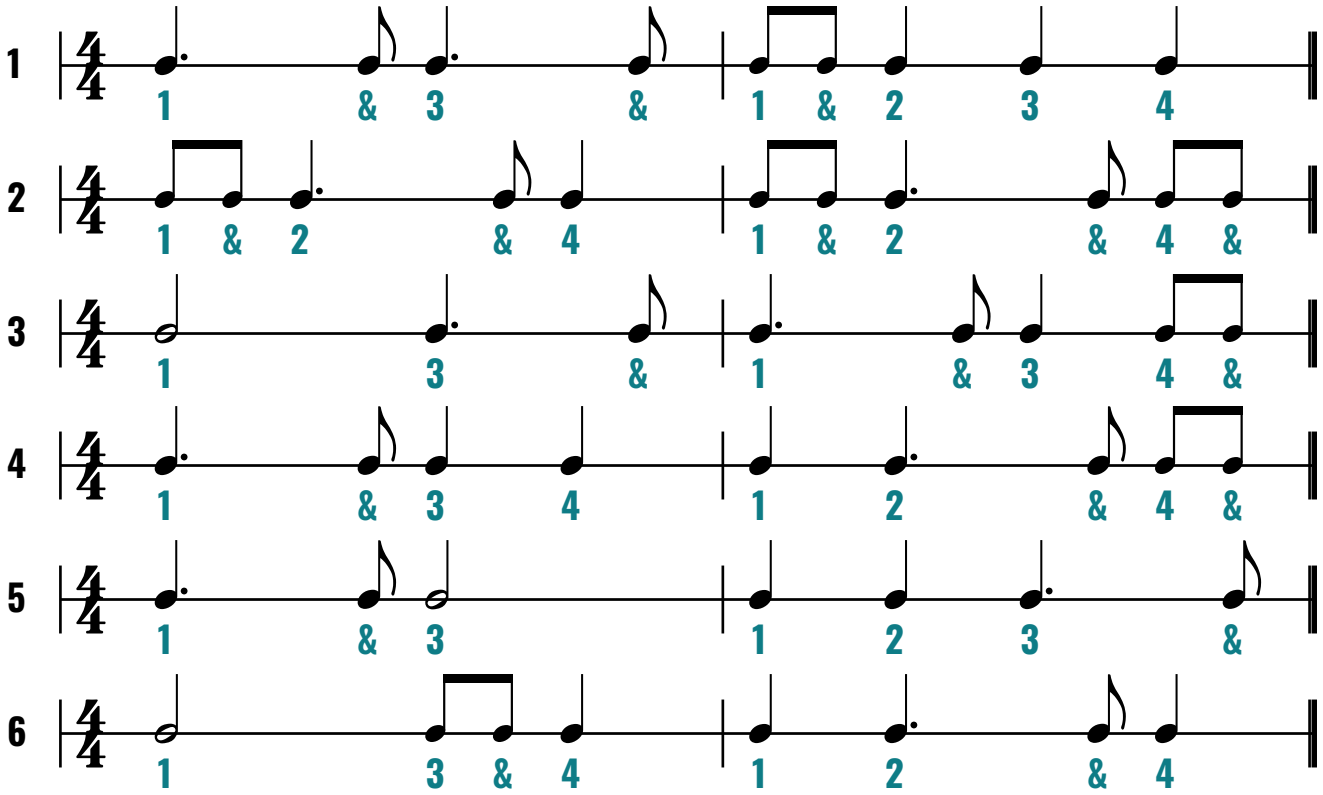
Worksheets 13 and 14

ANSWER KEY

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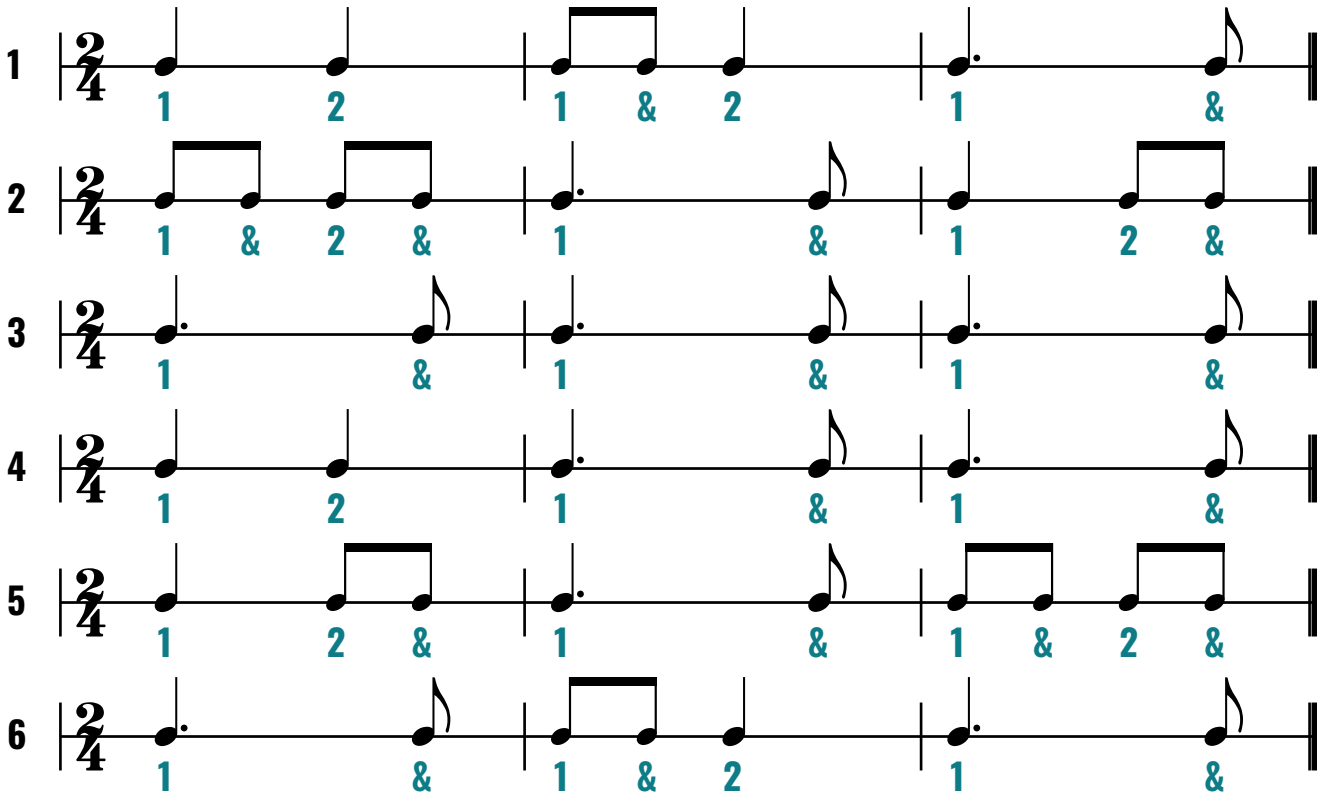
WORKSHEET 13 · Dotted quarter and eighth

page 16



WORKSHEET 14 · Dotted quarter and eighth in 2/4

page 17



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ANSWER KEY

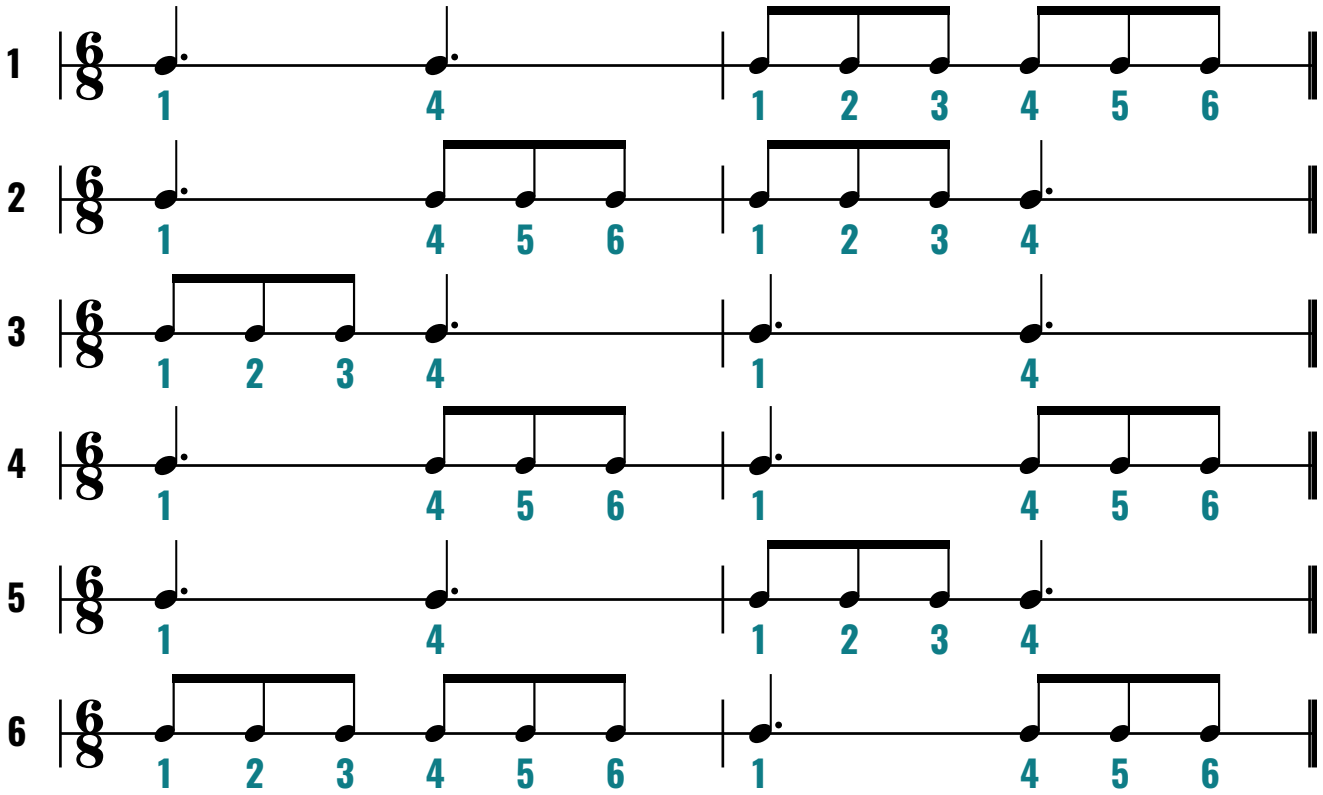
Worksheets 15 and 16

ANSWER KEY

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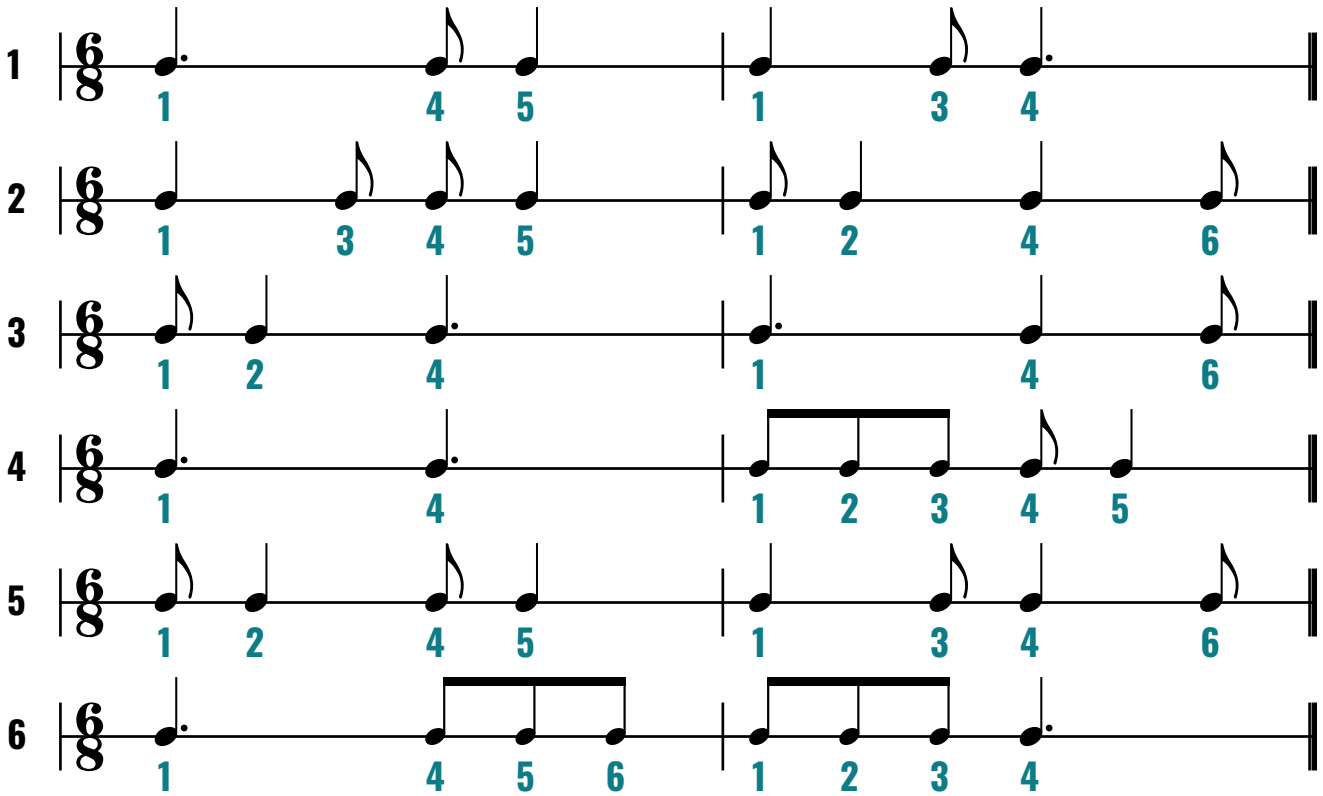
WORKSHEET 15 · Six-eight time: first steps

page 18



WORKSHEET 16 · Six-eight time: quarters and eighths

page 19



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ANSWER KEY

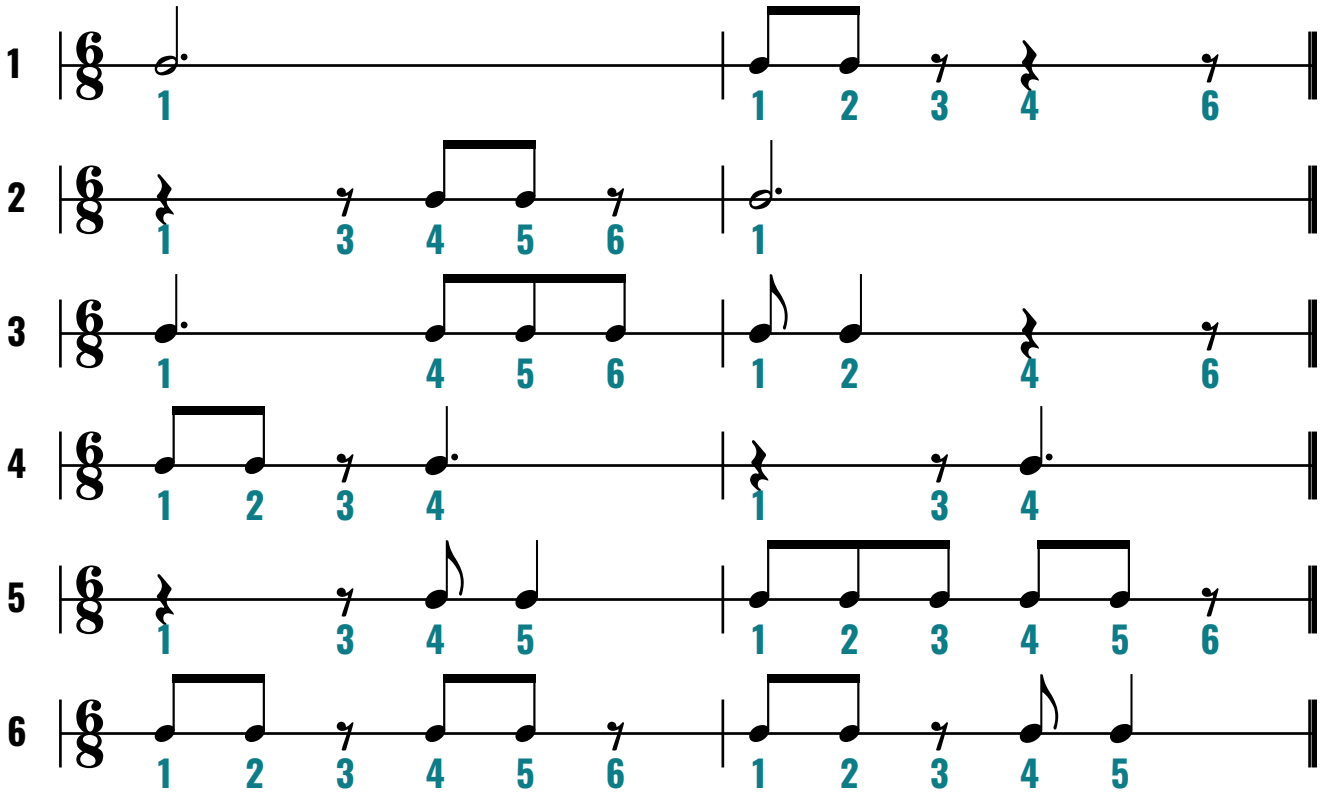
Worksheets 17 and 18

ANSWER KEY

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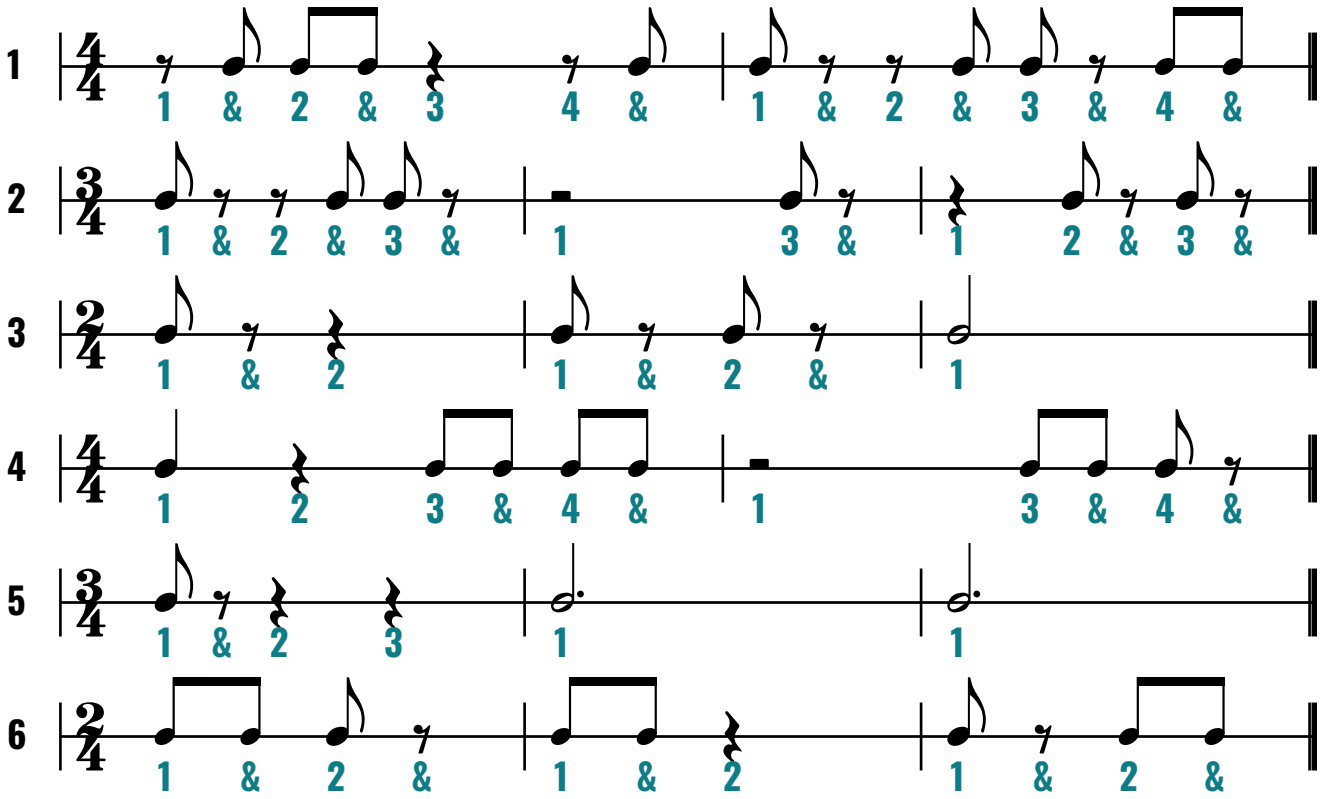
WORKSHEET 17 · Six-eight time: rests and dotted half

page 20



WORKSHEET 18 · Review: 4/4, 3/4 and 2/4

page 21



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ANSWER KEY

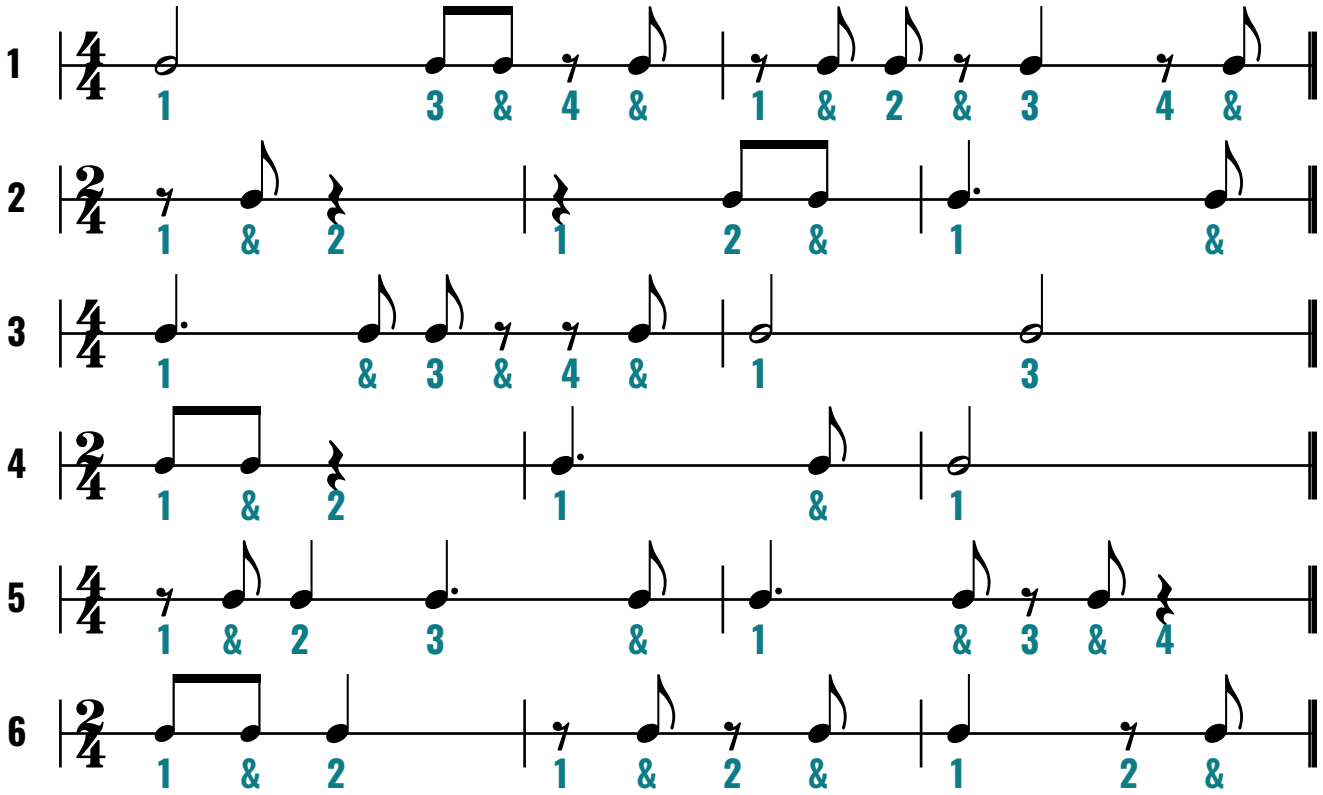
Worksheets 19 and 20

ANSWER KEY

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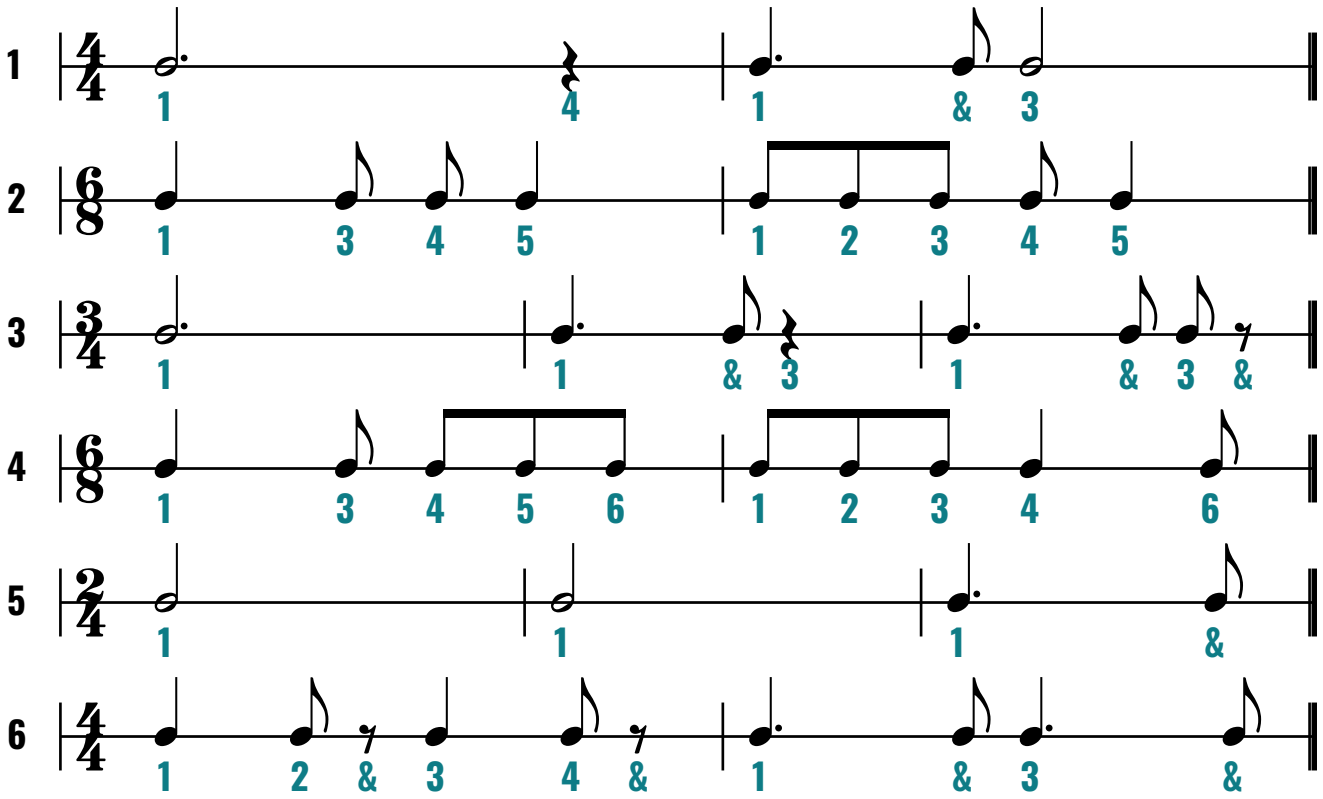
WORKSHEET 19 · Review: dotted rhythms and eighths

page 22



WORKSHEET 20 · Challenge: all the meters

page 23



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